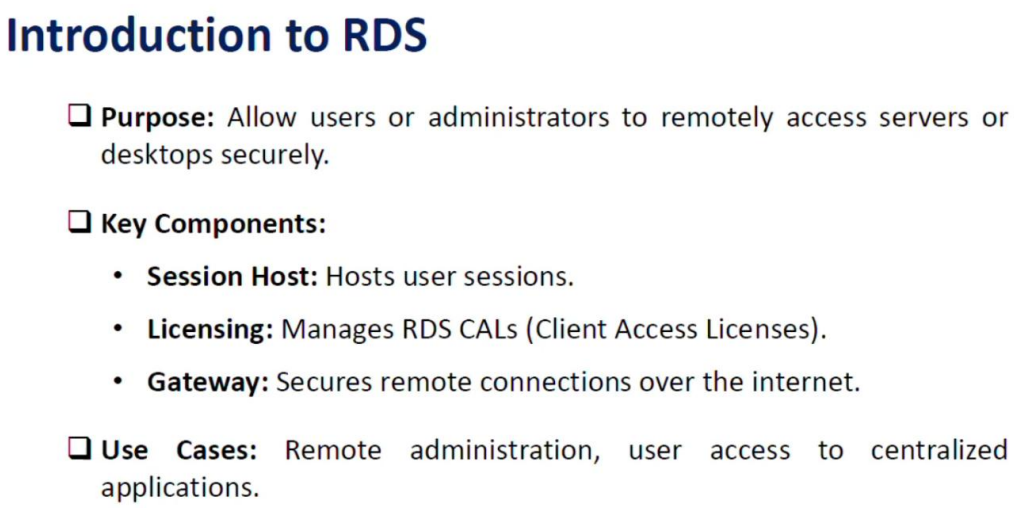
Remote Desktop Services (RDS) & VPN

Full Deployment, Licensing, Gateway and VPN (RRAS) Configuration Guide — Windows Server

Detailed walkthrough: every screenshot is explained — what it shows, what to click, and what result to expect — so the guide can be followed step-by-step without prior RDS/VPN experience.

Part 1 — Introduction to Remote Desktop Services (RDS)

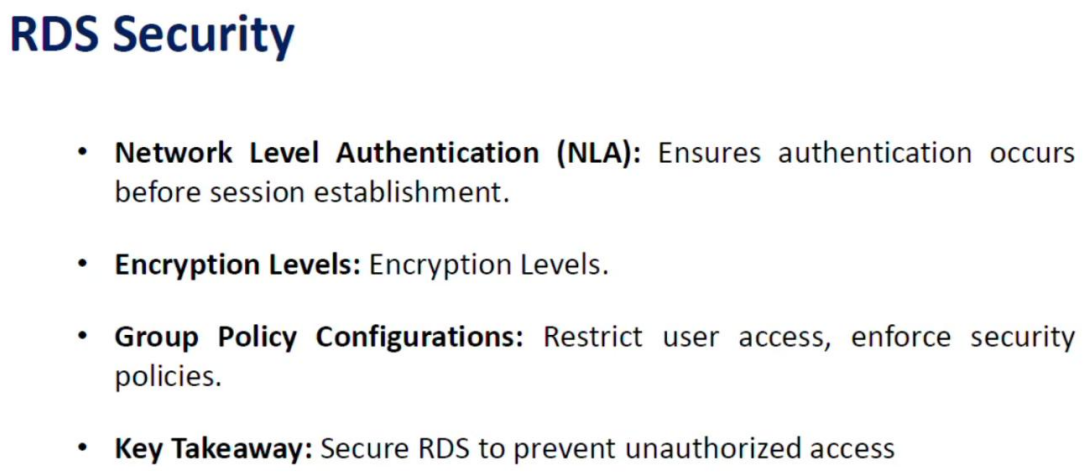
1.1 What is RDS?



What this screen shows: A summary slide defining RDS. Its purpose is to allow users or administrators to remotely access servers or desktops securely. The key components listed are the Session Host (hosts user sessions), Licensing (manages RDS CALs), and Gateway (secures remote connections over the internet).

What happens next: This is background theory — no action is taken on this slide. It sets up the vocabulary (Session Host, Licensing, Gateway) that the rest of the guide uses repeatedly, so keep these three terms in mind: they map directly to the RDS role services you will install later.

1.2 RDS Security Fundamentals



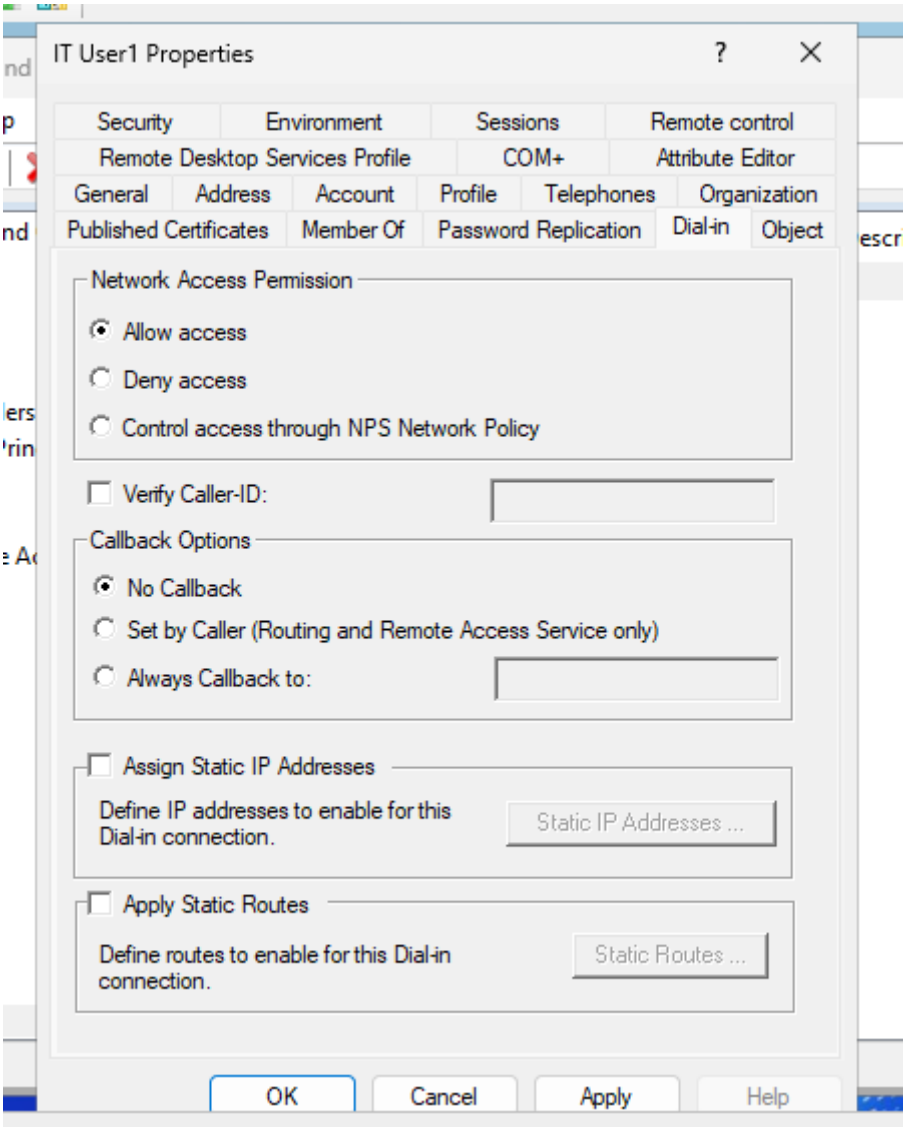
What this screen shows: A slide covering the security controls that protect an RDS deployment: Network Level Authentication (NLA), which forces the user to authenticate before a full desktop session is established (this blocks a lot of pre-authentication attacks); Encryption Levels, which control how strongly RDP traffic is encrypted; and Group Policy Configurations, which restrict what users can do once connected.

What happens next: Key takeaway: RDS must be secured deliberately (NLA on, encryption enforced, tightly scoped group policies) — an RDS deployment with default settings and no CALs is not something you expose directly to the internet. This is why the guide later installs RD Gateway instead of forwarding RDP port 3389 straight through the firewall.

1.3 Granting a User Remote Desktop Access in Active Directory

Before installing the RDS role itself, the first practical task is to make sure a specific Active Directory user account is actually permitted to use Remote Desktop. This is done from Active Directory Users and Computers (ADUC), on the user's Properties sheet.

1.3.1 The Dial-in tab — Network Access Permission

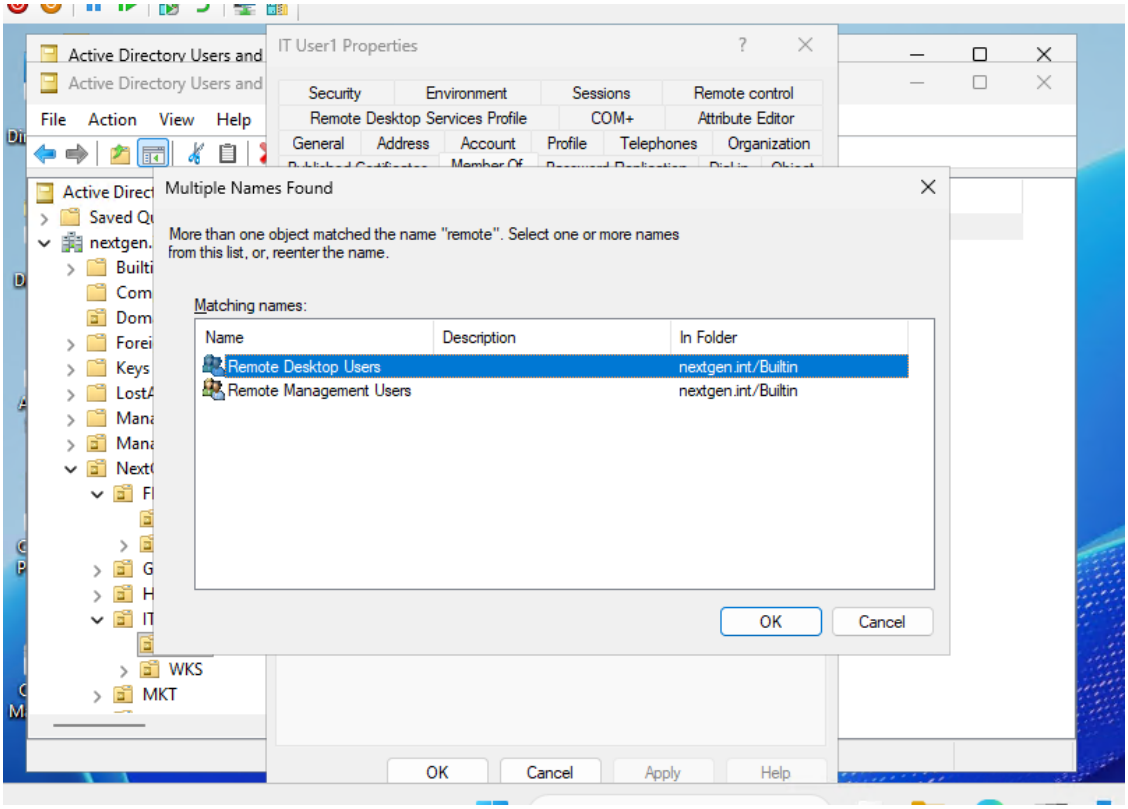


What this screen shows: This is the 'IT User1 Properties' window opened from Active Directory Users and Computers, on the Dial-in tab. Under Network Access Permission there are three radio buttons: Allow access, Deny access, and Control access through NPS Network Policy. Below that are Callback Options (No Callback / Set by Caller / Always Callback to) and options to assign static IP addresses or static routes for the connection.

What to do here: Select Allow access so the account is explicitly permitted to dial in remotely. Leave Callback Options on No Callback (the default) unless the organisation specifically uses callback security, and leave the static IP/route options unchecked for a normal RDS user. Click Apply, then OK.

What happens next: The user account is now flagged as allowed to make an inbound remote-access connection (this same tab is reused later for VPN users, since RRAS/VPN dial-in permission is controlled in exactly the same place).

1.3.2 Adding the account to the Remote Desktop Users group

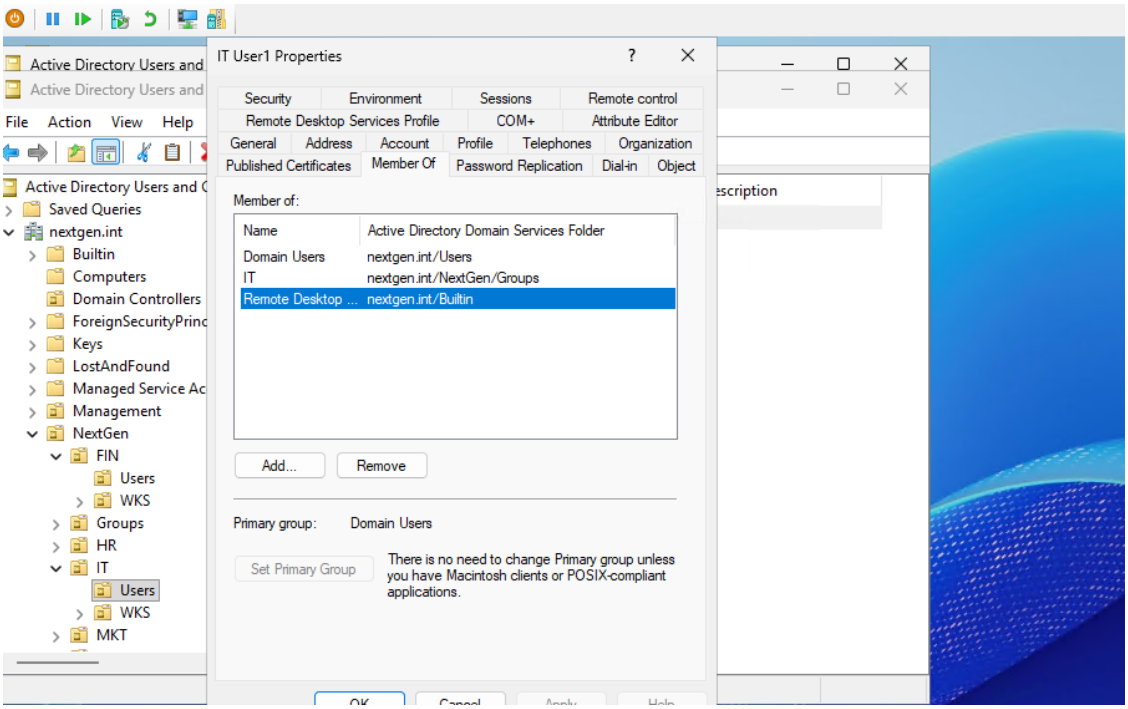


What this screen shows: This shows the Member Of tab while searching for a group to add. A 'Multiple Names Found' dialog has appeared because typing "remote" matched two similarly named built-in groups: Remote Desktop Users and Remote Management Users, both located in nextgen.int/Builtin.

What to do here: Select Remote Desktop Users (not Remote Management Users — that group is for WinRM/PowerShell remoting, not RDP) and click OK.

What happens next: Windows resolves the ambiguous name to the correct group object and adds it to the list of groups the wizard will apply.

1.3.3 Confirming group membership



What this screen shows: The left window shows the Active Directory Users and Computers console tree (the nextgen.int domain, expanded down to the IT organisational unit and its Users container). The right-hand 'IT User1 Properties' window, Member Of tab, now lists the groups the account belongs to: Domain Users (primary group) and Remote Desktop... (nextgen.int/Builtin) — the group just added in the previous step.

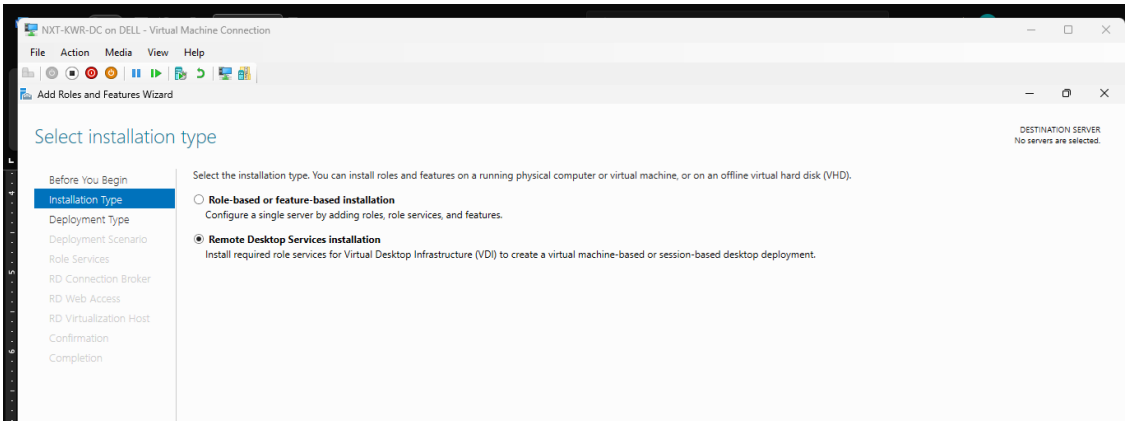
What to do here: Review the list, confirm Remote Desktop Users is present, then click Apply and OK. There is no need to change the Primary Group — Word notes that Primary Group only matters for Macintosh clients or POSIX-compliant applications, so Domain Users can stay as the primary group.

What happens next: The user account nextgen.int\IT\User1 is now both (a) allowed to dial in (previous tab) and (b) a member of the Remote Desktop Users security group, which is the group Windows checks before allowing an RDP logon to a session host. This user can now be used to test the RDS deployment once it is installed.

1.4 Installing the Remote Desktop Services Role

With a test user authorised, the next step is to actually install the RDS role on the server using the Add Roles and Features Wizard, choosing the Remote Desktop Services installation path (rather than a plain role-based install) because this unlocks the RDS-specific deployment wizard (deployment type, deployment scenario, and role placement) instead of just installing a single Windows feature.

1.4.1 Select installation type

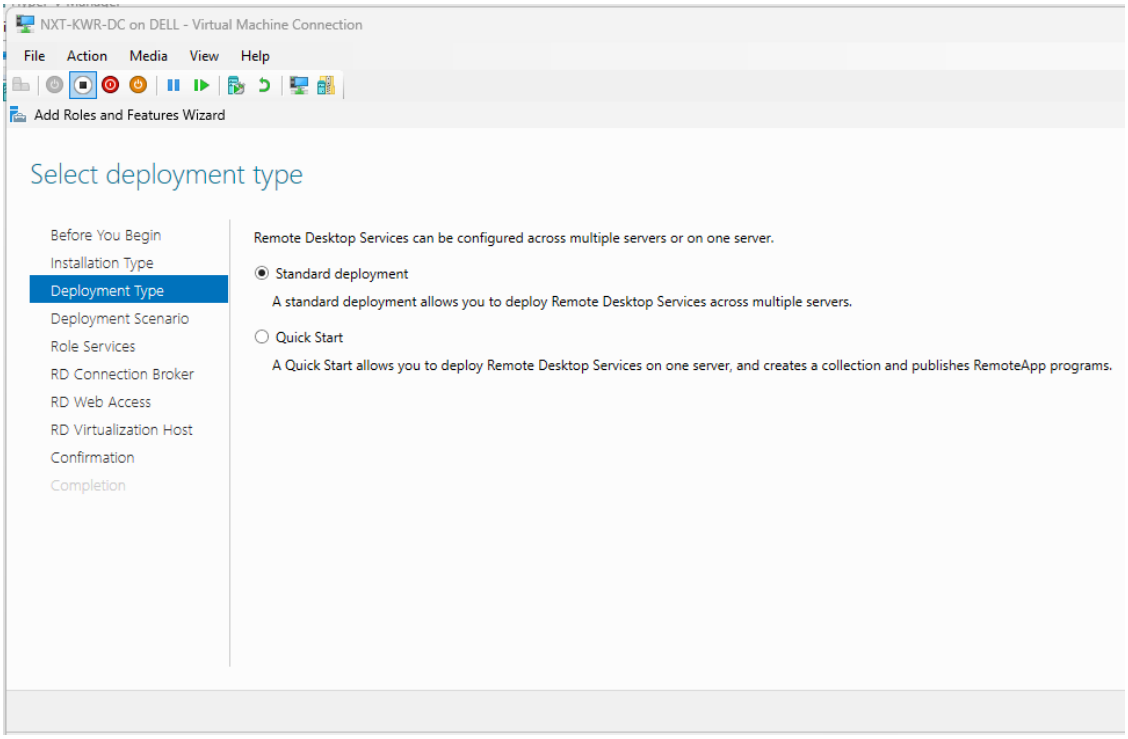


What this screen shows: The Add Roles and Features Wizard, Installation Type step. Two options are offered: Role-based or feature-based installation (a single server or VM) or Remote Desktop Services installation, described as installing the roles needed for Virtual Machine-based or session-based desktop infrastructure (VDI).

What to do here: Choose Remote Desktop Services installation, then click Next.

What happens next: The wizard switches into RDS deployment mode and will next ask for the deployment type (Standard vs Quick Start) instead of the normal generic role checklist.

1.4.2 Select deployment type

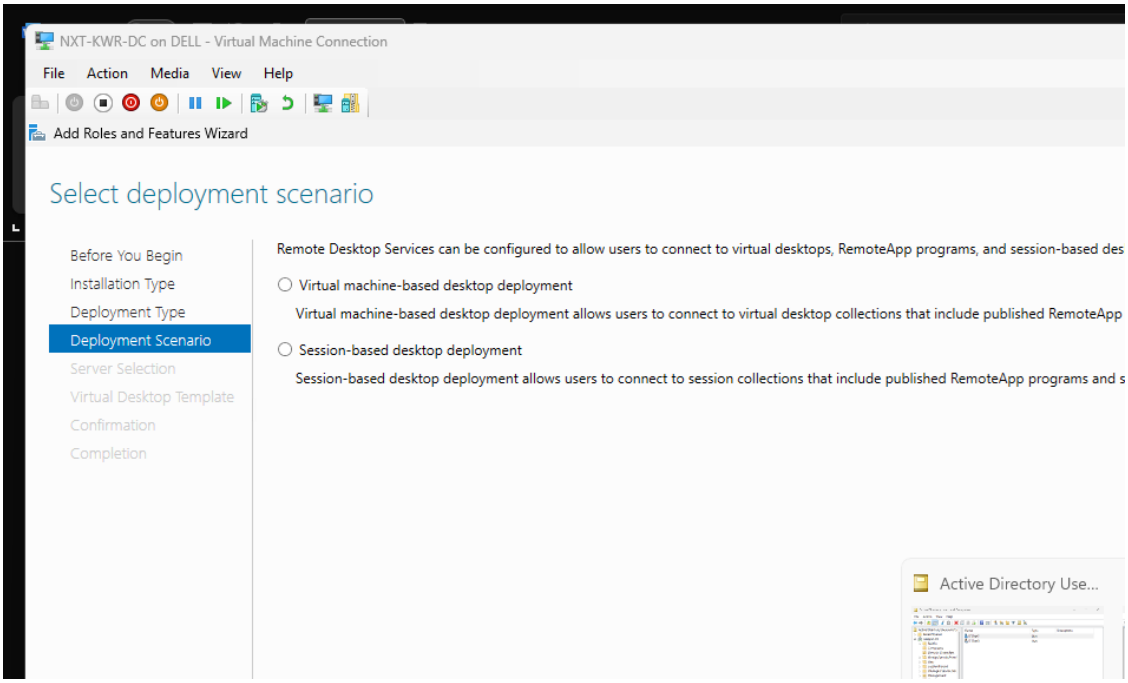


What this screen shows: The Deployment Type page offers Standard deployment ("allows you to deploy Remote Desktop Services across multiple servers") and Quick Start ("allows you to deploy Remote Desktop Services on one server, and creates a collection and publishes RemoteApp programs").

What to do here: For a lab or small environment where every RDS role will live on a single server, choose Quick Start (as the accompanying notes in the document describe). For a production environment where roles should be spread across multiple servers for performance, scalability and availability, choose Standard deployment instead.

What happens next: Quick Start collapses several wizard pages into one streamlined flow and will automatically create a session collection at the end; Standard deployment instead walks through selecting a server for each individual role service one at a time.

1.4.3 Select deployment scenario



What this screen shows: The Deployment Scenario page (shown for the Quick Start path) presents two options: Virtual machine-based desktop deployment (users connect to full virtual desktops, useful for VDI collections) and Session-based desktop deployment (users connect to shared session collections that include published RemoteApp programs and desktop sessions on a shared session host).

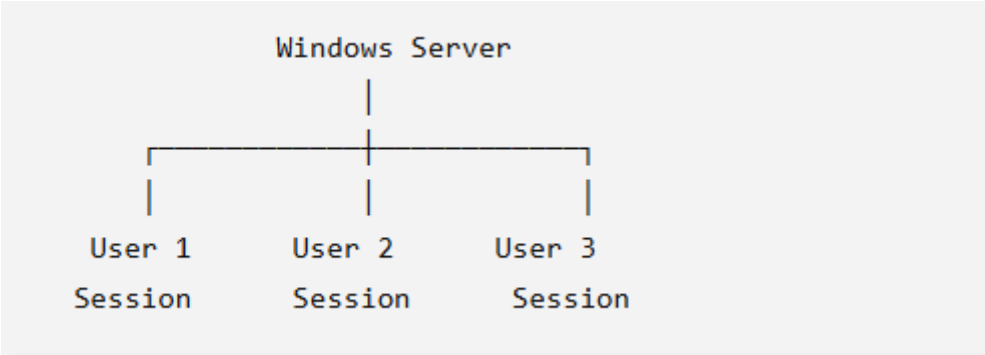
What to do here: Select Session-based desktop deployment — this is the model used throughout the rest of this guide, where many users share one Session Host and are published individual RemoteApp programs (Calculator, Notepad, Paint, XPS Viewer) rather than each getting a full personal VM.

What happens next: The wizard proceeds to server selection, where the RD Session Host role will be installed on the chosen server (in this case NXT-KWR-DC).

Reference: RDS Deployment Models

Two conceptual diagrams from the source material are worth keeping in mind while choosing between the options above:

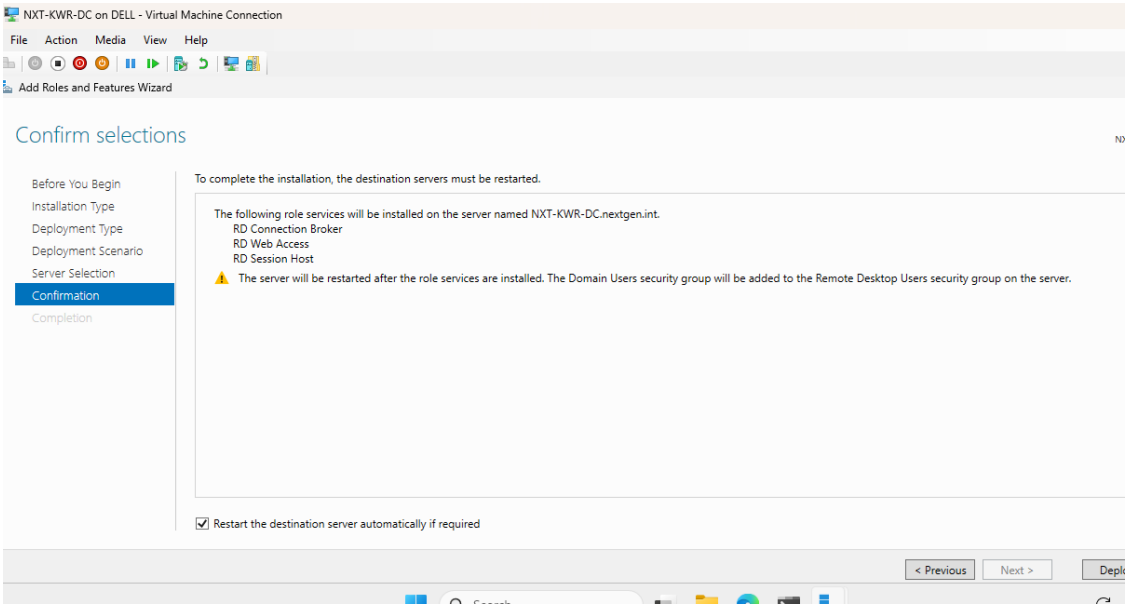
Session-based desktop model



What this screen shows: A simple tree diagram: a single Windows Server at the top, branching down to User 1 Session, User 2 Session, and User 3 Session.

What happens next: This illustrates exactly what Session-based desktop deployment (chosen above) provides: every user logs into the same underlying Windows Server operating system, but each gets an isolated session. This is efficient because only one OS instance needs to be patched and maintained, but it means users share the server's CPU, memory and disk.

1.4.4 Confirming the selections and deploying



What this screen shows: The Confirm selections page lists exactly which role services will be installed on NXT-KWR-DC.nextgen.int: RD Connection Broker, RD Web Access, and RD Session Host. A warning icon notes the server will be restarted automatically once the role services are installed, and the Domain Users security group will be added to the Remote Desktop Users security group on the server. The 'Restart the destination server automatically if required' checkbox is ticked.

What to do here: Leave the automatic-restart box ticked (unless there is a reason the server cannot reboot right now) and click Deploy.

What happens next: Windows installs the RD Connection Broker, RD Web Access and RD Session Host role services in sequence, then automatically reboots the server to finish the

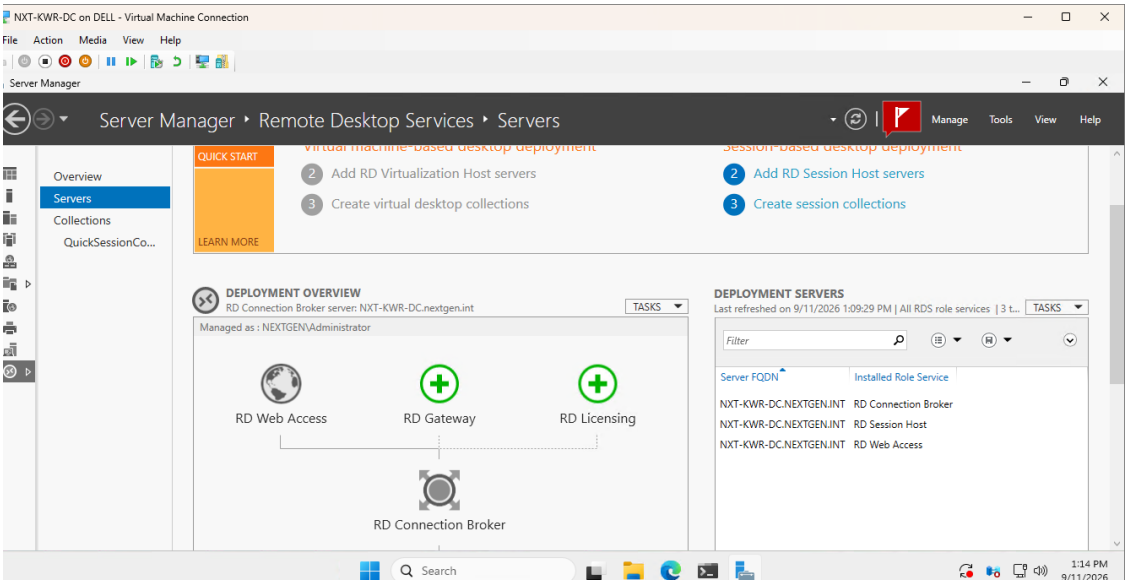
What this screen shows: A branding slide listing well-known commercial and open-source VPN products: Cisco AnyConnect, Fortinet VPN, Palo Alto GlobalProtect, OpenVPN, and WireGuard, with their respective logos.

What happens next: Shown for awareness of alternatives — this guide specifically uses Windows Server's own built-in Routing and Remote Access Service (RRAS) rather than any of these third-party products, because RRAS is already licensed as part of Windows Server and integrates directly with Active Directory for authentication.

Part 3 — RD Licensing and RD Gateway

Returning to the RDS deployment from Part 1: without an RD Licensing server, Windows Server only permits two simultaneous Remote Desktop connections, intended for administration only. To let ordinary users run applications or full desktops through RDS, an RD Licensing role service must be installed and CALs issued to it. Immediately after that, this section also installs RD Gateway so that remote clients can reach the deployment securely over HTTPS instead of exposing RDP directly.

3.1 The RDS deployment overview in Server Manager

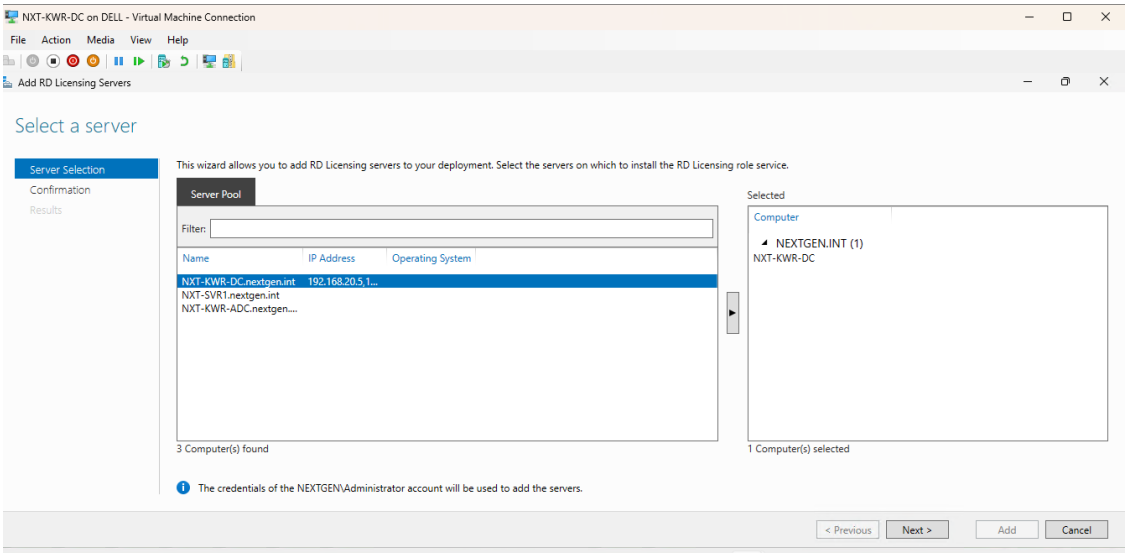


What this screen shows: Server Manager → Remote Desktop Services → Overview. A deployment diagram shows the roles installed so far — RD Web Access, RD Gateway, and RD Licensing — as icons connected to a central RD Connection Broker icon. Green plus-circle icons next to RD Gateway and RD Licensing indicate these roles are not yet configured/added; the right-hand panel lists deployment servers and which role services are already installed on each.

What to do here: Click the green plus icon next to RD Licensing to begin adding that role service to the deployment.

What happens next: The Add RD Licensing Servers wizard opens (next screenshot).

3.2 Selecting a server for RD Licensing

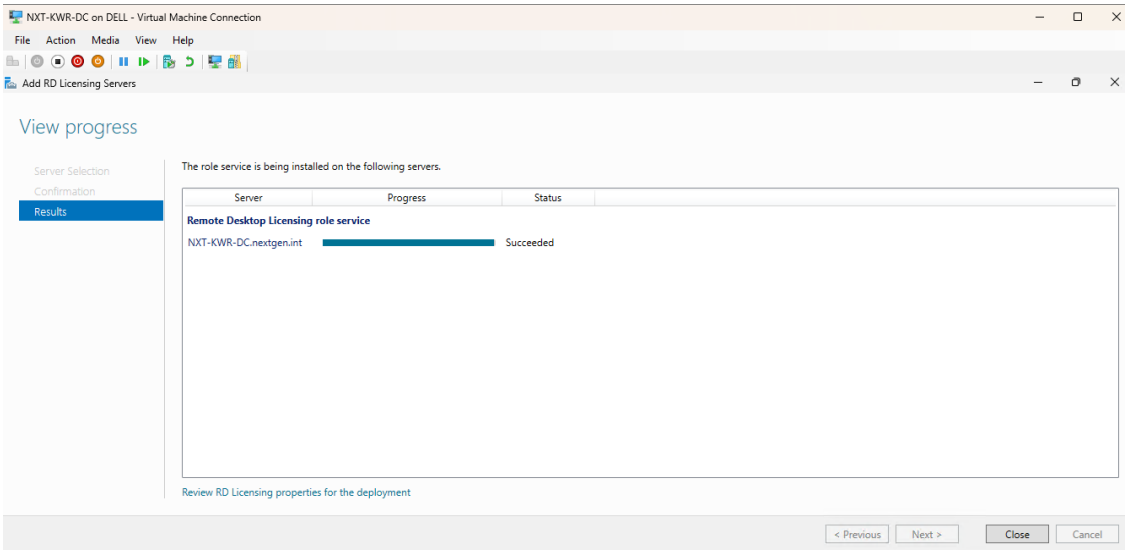


What this screen shows: The Add RD Licensing Servers wizard, Server Selection step. A Server Pool list shows the discovered servers on the left (NXT-KWR-DC.nextgen.int, NXT-SVR1.nextgen.int, NXT-ADC.nextgen...) with their IP addresses and operating systems; the Selected list on the right currently contains NXT-KWR-DC (the server this deployment is centred on).

What to do here: With NXT-KWR-DC already in the Selected column, click Next (there is no need to add another server unless licensing should live on a separate machine).

What happens next: The wizard proceeds to install the RD Licensing role service on NXT-KWR-DC.

3.3 RD Licensing installation progress

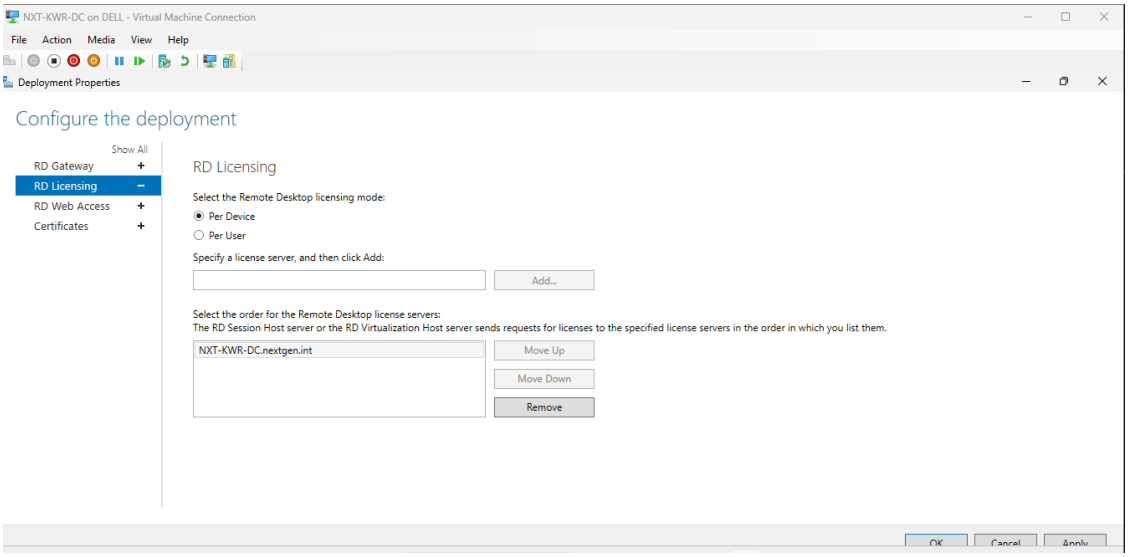


What this screen shows: The View progress page shows a progress bar for 'Remote Desktop Licensing role service' on NXT-KWR-DC.nextgen.int, which reaches Succeeded.

What to do here: Click Close once the status shows Succeeded.

What happens next: The RD Licensing role service is now installed on the server, but it still has no license mode or license server configured — that is set up next in Deployment Properties.

3.4 Configuring RD Licensing mode and license server



What this screen shows: The Deployment Properties dialog, RD Licensing page. It offers a choice between Per Device and Per User licensing modes, and a box to 'Specify a license server, and then click Add' — with NXT-KWR-DC.nextgen.int already listed in the box below as a specified license server, along with Move Up / Move Down / Remove controls that control the order servers are queried in.

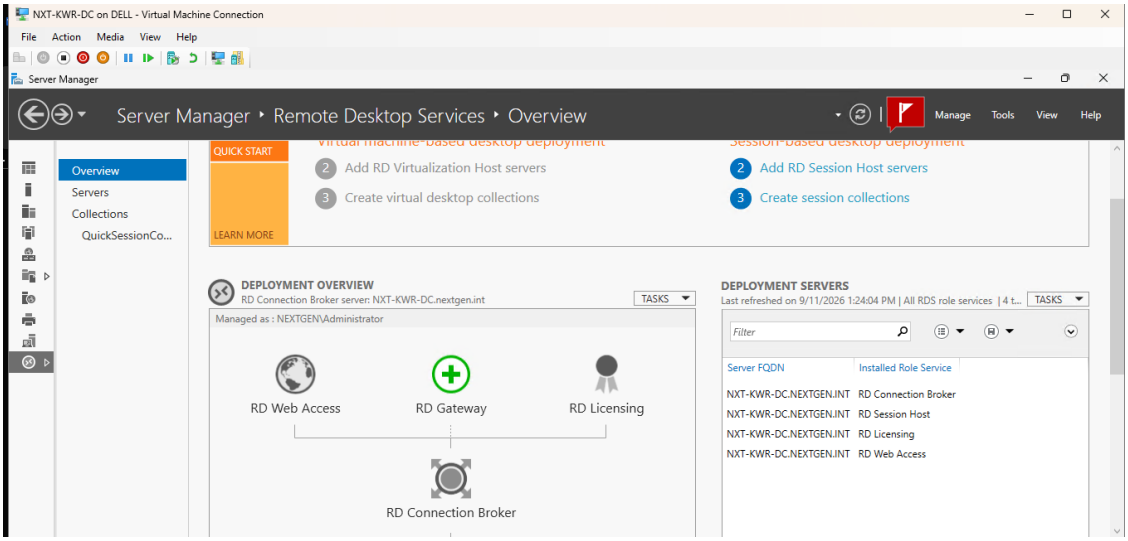
What to do here: Choose Per Device if each physical/virtual client machine should consume one CAL regardless of how many users log in from it, or Per User if each named user should consume one CAL regardless of how many devices they connect from (Per User is more common for a workforce that roams across laptops/desktops). Confirm the license server list contains NXT-KWR-DC.nextgen.int, then click Apply and OK.

What happens next: The RD Session Host now knows which license server to request CALs from, and in which licensing mode. As noted in the source material, Windows Server also allows a 180-day free grace period using CALs from the evaluation ISO, which is useful for testing before purchasing real CALs.

3.5 Installing RD Gateway

RD Gateway lets remote users connect over HTTPS (TCP 443) instead of exposing RDP (TCP 3389) directly to the internet. The RD Gateway authenticates the user and then relays the RDP session internally, so the RDS Session Host itself is never directly reachable from outside.

3.5.1 Starting the RD Gateway install

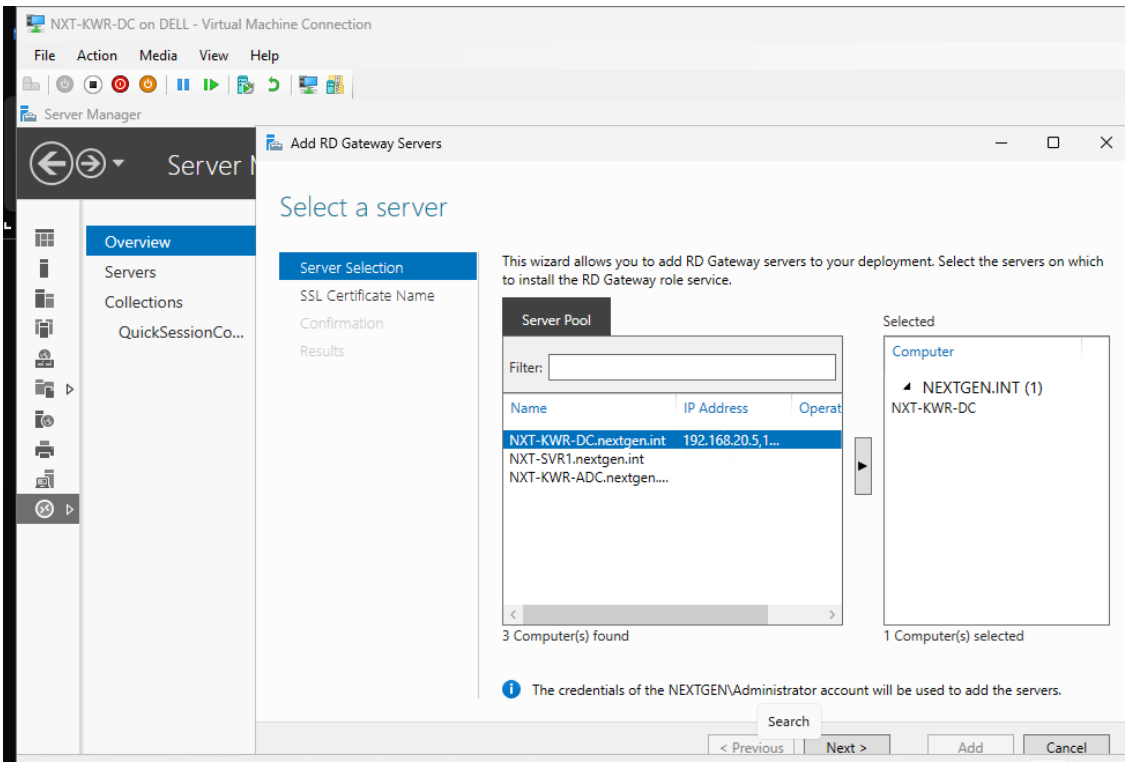


What this screen shows: Server Manager → Remote Desktop Services → Overview, the same deployment diagram as before, now with RD Licensing showing as configured. RD Web Access and RD Gateway icons remain, with RD Gateway still showing the green plus-circle indicating it hasn't been added yet.

What to do here: Click the plus icon on RD Gateway.

What happens next: The Add RD Gateway Servers wizard opens.

3.5.2 Selecting a server for RD Gateway

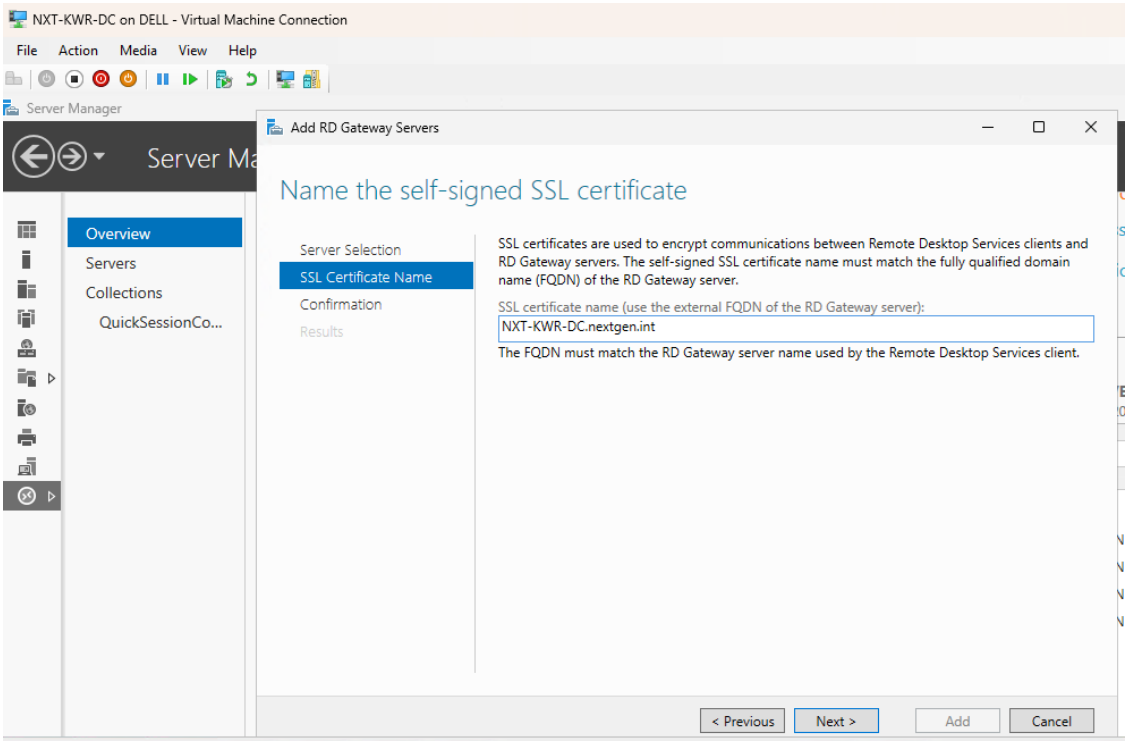


What this screen shows: The Add RD Gateway Servers wizard, Server Selection step — the same server pool as before (NXT-KWR-DC.nextgen.int, NXT-SVR1.nextgen.int, NXT-KWR-ADC.nextgen...), with NXT-KWR-DC already selected on the right.

What to do here: Click Next to proceed with NXT-KWR-DC as the RD Gateway server.

What happens next: The wizard moves to the SSL Certificate Name step, since RD Gateway requires HTTPS and therefore a certificate whose name matches how clients will reach it.

3.5.3 Naming the self-signed SSL certificate

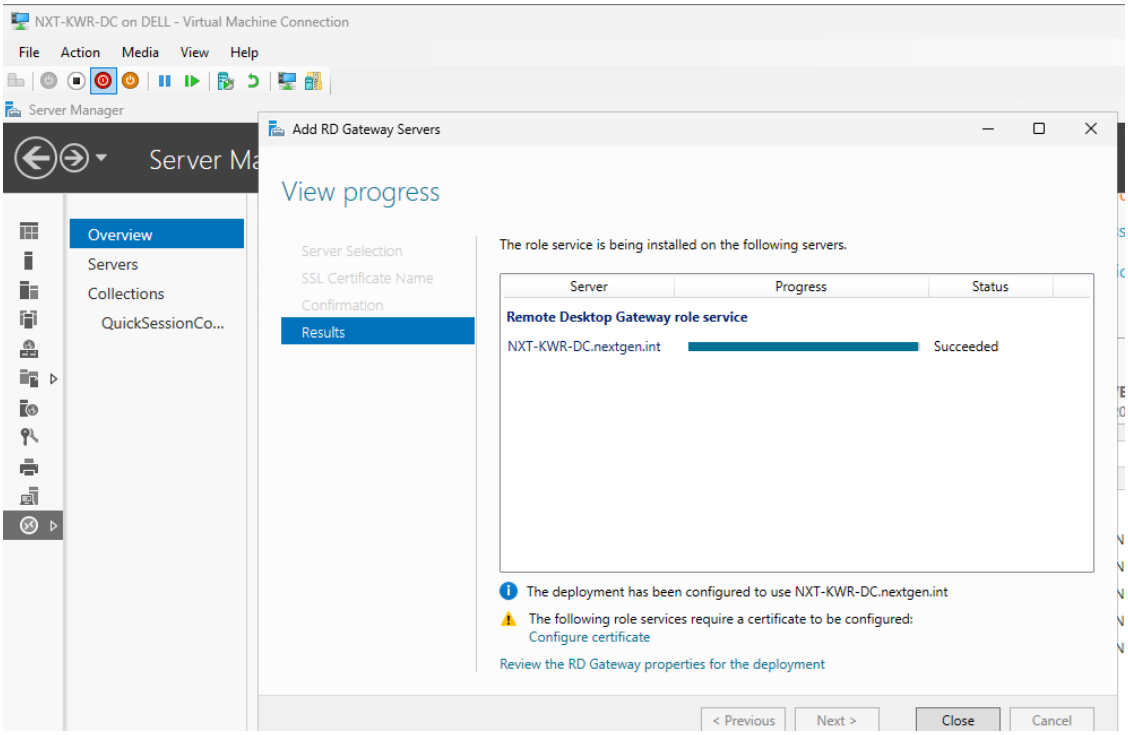


What this screen shows: The Name the self-signed SSL certificate page explains that the certificate name must match the fully qualified domain name (FQDN) that RD Gateway clients will use to connect. The field is pre-filled with NXT-KWR-DC.nextgen.int.

What to do here: Confirm the FQDN shown matches the name clients will actually type/connect to (Hostname + Domain Name, e.g. NXT-KWR-DC.nextgen.int), then click Next.

What happens next: The wizard installs the RD Gateway role service using this certificate name as its identity.

3.5.4 RD Gateway installation progress



What this screen shows: The View progress page shows the Remote Desktop Gateway role service installing on NXT-KWR-DC.nextgen.int, reaching Succeeded. A note below states the deployment has been configured to use NXT-KWR-DC.nextgen.int, but warns that the following role services still require a certificate to be configured, with a Configure certificate link.

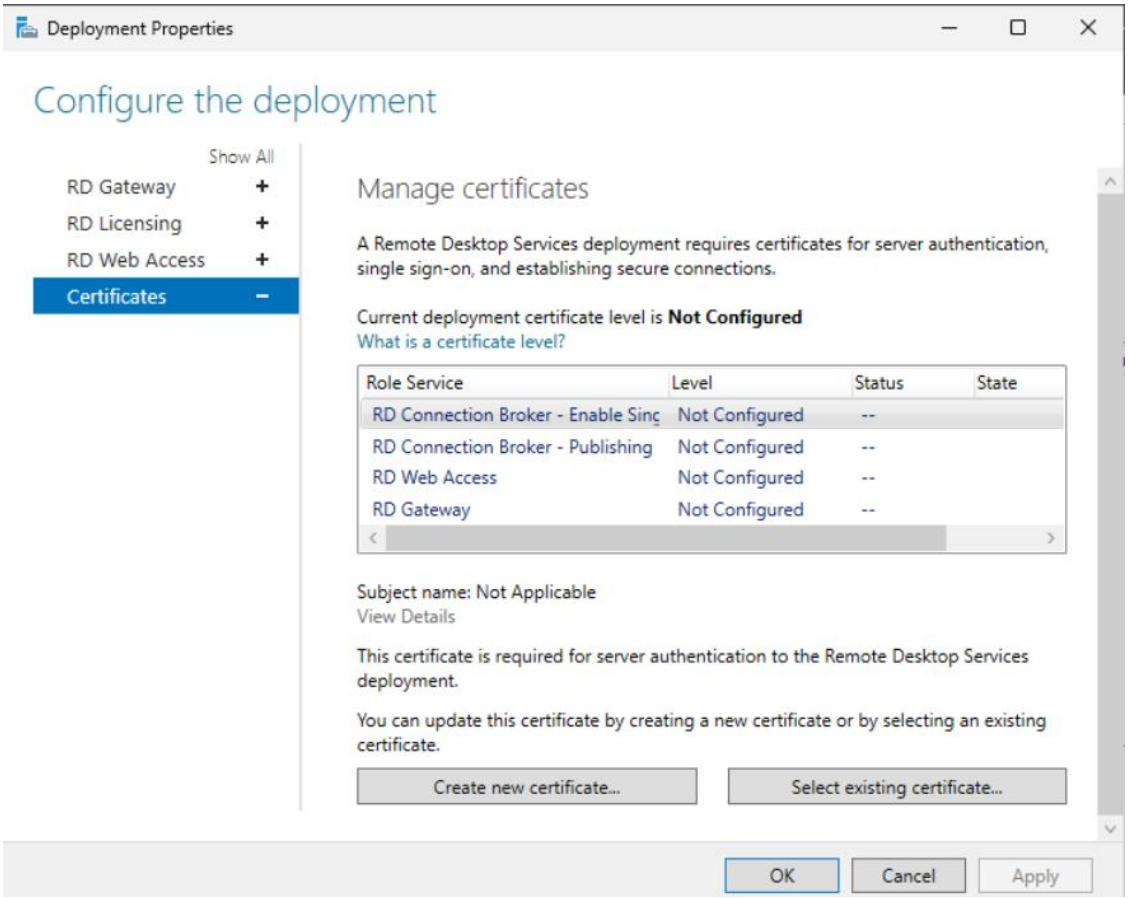
What to do here: Click the Configure certificate link (or close this dialog and open Deployment Properties → Certificates afterwards).

What happens next: The Deployment Properties → Certificates page opens, where an actual certificate now needs to be created or selected for RD Gateway to use for HTTPS.

3.6 Creating and assigning the SSL certificate

RD Gateway needs a real certificate (not just a name) bound to it before HTTPS clients can connect without warnings. Two routes are shown: creating a brand-new self-signed certificate from inside the RDS wizard, and — as an alternative — creating/managing certificates centrally through IIS Manager and then pointing RD Gateway at an existing one.

3.6.1 Manage certificates screen

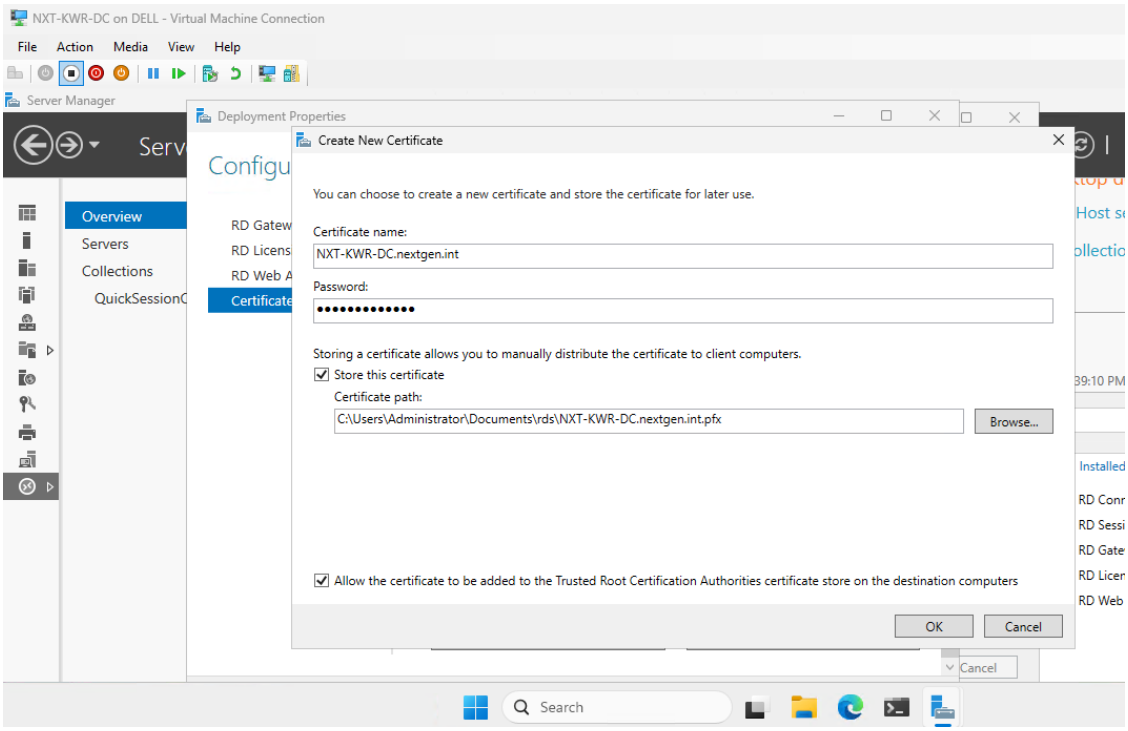


What this screen shows: Deployment Properties → Certificates page. A table lists each role service that needs a certificate — RD Connection Broker - Enable Single Sign-On, RD Connection Broker - Publishing, RD Web Access, and RD Gateway — each currently showing Level: Not Configured. The current deployment certificate level at the top reads 'Not Configured'. Two buttons are offered at the bottom: Create new certificate... and Select existing certificate...

What to do here: Since no certificate exists yet, click Create new certificate...

What happens next: The Create New Certificate dialog opens (next screenshot).

3.6.2 Creating a new self-signed certificate



What this screen shows: The Create New Certificate dialog. Fields shown: Certificate name (pre-filled NXT-KWR-DC.nextgen.int), Password and confirm password (masked), a 'Store this certificate' checkbox (ticked) with a Certificate path pointing to C:\Users\Administrator\Documents\...\NXT-KWR-DC.nextgen.int.pfx, and a checkbox 'Allow the certificate to be added to the Trusted Root Certification Authorities certificate store on the destination computers' (ticked).

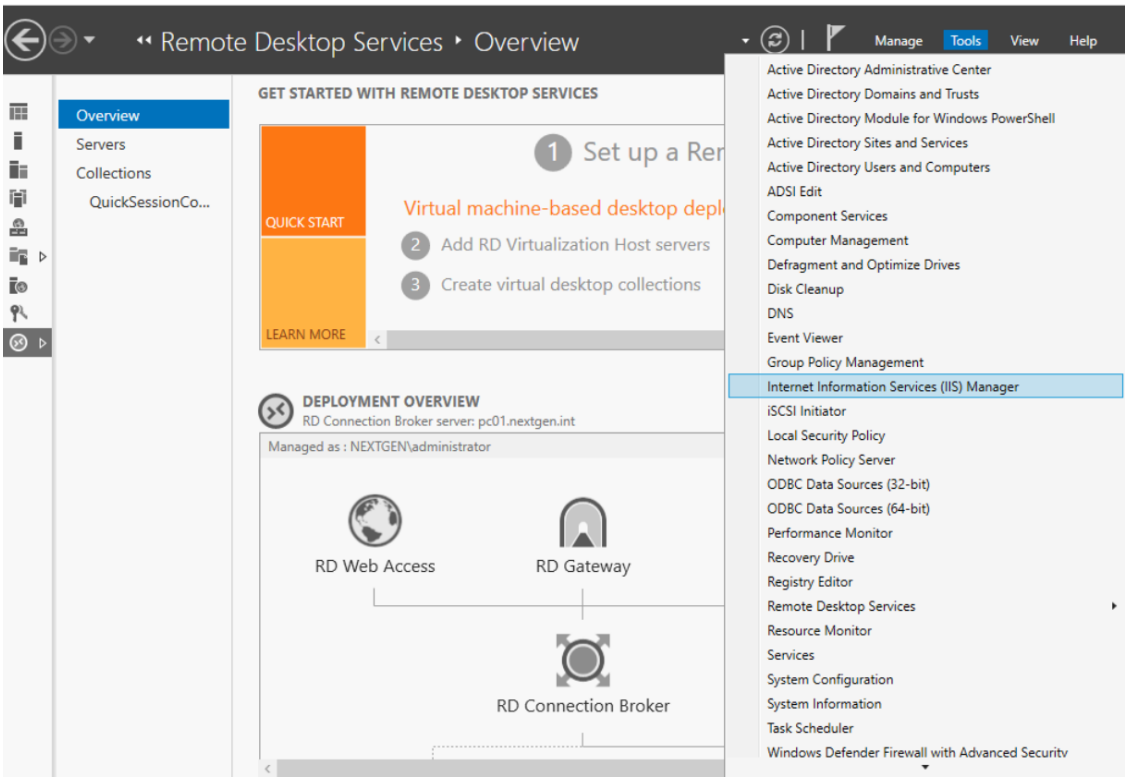
What to do here: Leave the certificate name matching the server's FQDN, set and confirm a strong password (this password will be needed again later when importing the certificate on client machines), keep 'Store this certificate' ticked so a .pfx backup file is saved at the shown path, keep the Trusted Root option ticked so clients trust it automatically, then click OK.

What happens next: A new self-signed certificate is generated, applied to the RD Gateway (and other) role services, and also exported as a .pfx file to the path shown — that .pfx file is exactly what gets imported onto client PCs later in Part 3.8 so their browsers/RDP clients trust the RD Gateway's HTTPS certificate.

3.7 Alternative: managing certificates through IIS Manager

The document also shows how certificates can be viewed and issued centrally through Internet Information Services (IIS) Manager, which is useful when a server hosts multiple HTTPS-dependent roles (RD Web Access uses IIS underneath) and certificates need to be managed in one place.

3.7.1 Opening IIS Manager from Server Manager

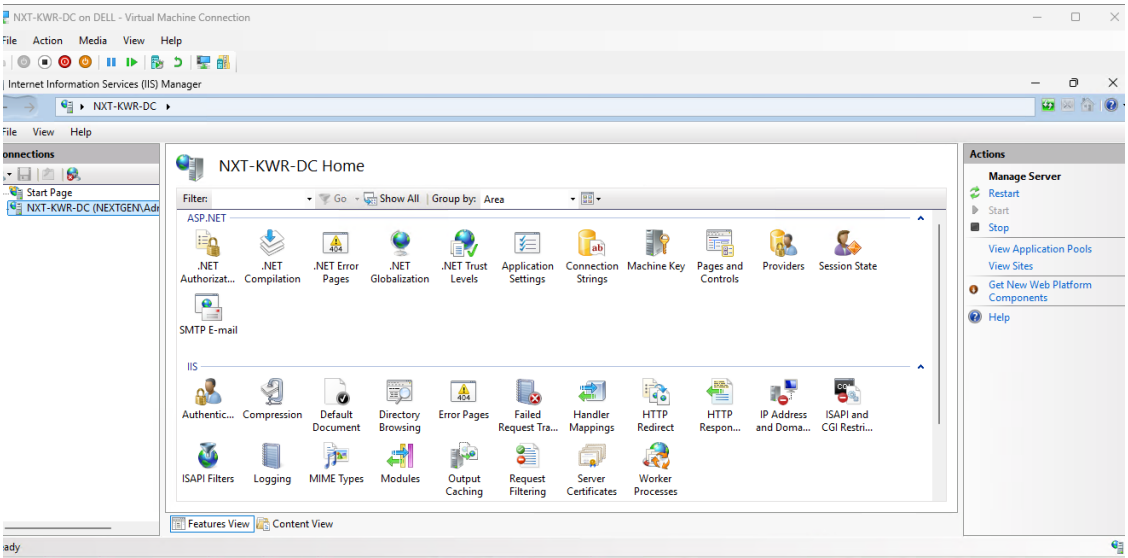


What this screen shows: Server Manager, with the Tools menu open showing the list of available management consoles — Active Directory Administrative Center, Active Directory Domains and Trusts, … Internet Information Services (IIS) Manager (highlighted), Local Security Policy, Network Policy Server, and others.

What to do here: Click Internet Information Services (IIS) Manager.

What happens next: The IIS Manager console opens, showing the local server's sites and application pools.

3.7.2 The IIS Manager home page

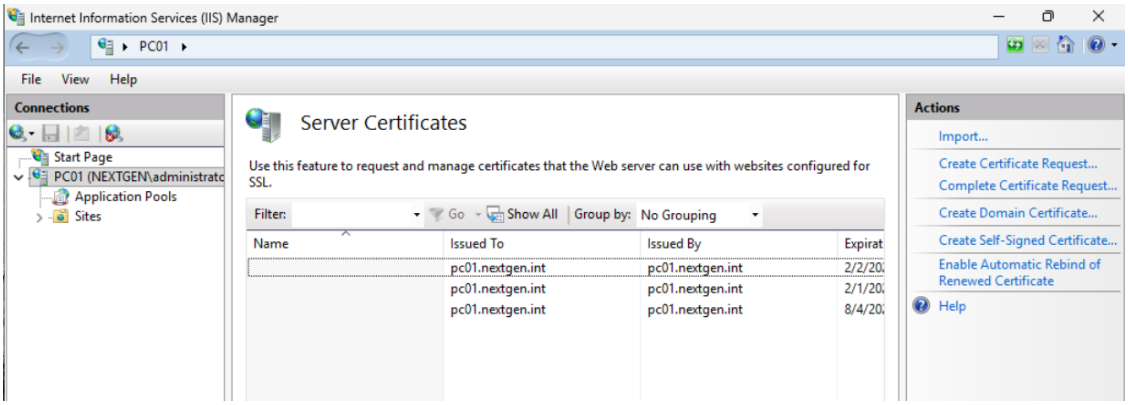


What this screen shows: IIS Manager connected to NXT-KWR-DC, showing the server's Home page with the standard IIS feature icon grid: .NET Authorization, .NET Compilation, .NET Error Pages, .NET Trust Levels, Application Settings, Connection Strings, Machine Key, Pages and Controls, Providers, Session State, SMTP E-mail, and further down ASP.NET/IIS-level icons including Authentication, Compression, Default Document, Directory Browsing, Error Pages, Handler Mappings, HTTP Redirect, HTTP Response Headers, IP Address and Domain Restrictions, ISAPI Filters, Logging, MIME Types, Modules, Output Caching, Request Filtering, Server Certificates, and Worker Processes.

What to do here: Locate and click the Server Certificates icon (used to view/manage the machine-level certificate store that IIS-based sites, including RD Web Access, draw from).

What happens next: The Server Certificates management page opens (next screenshot).

3.7.3 Server Certificates in IIS

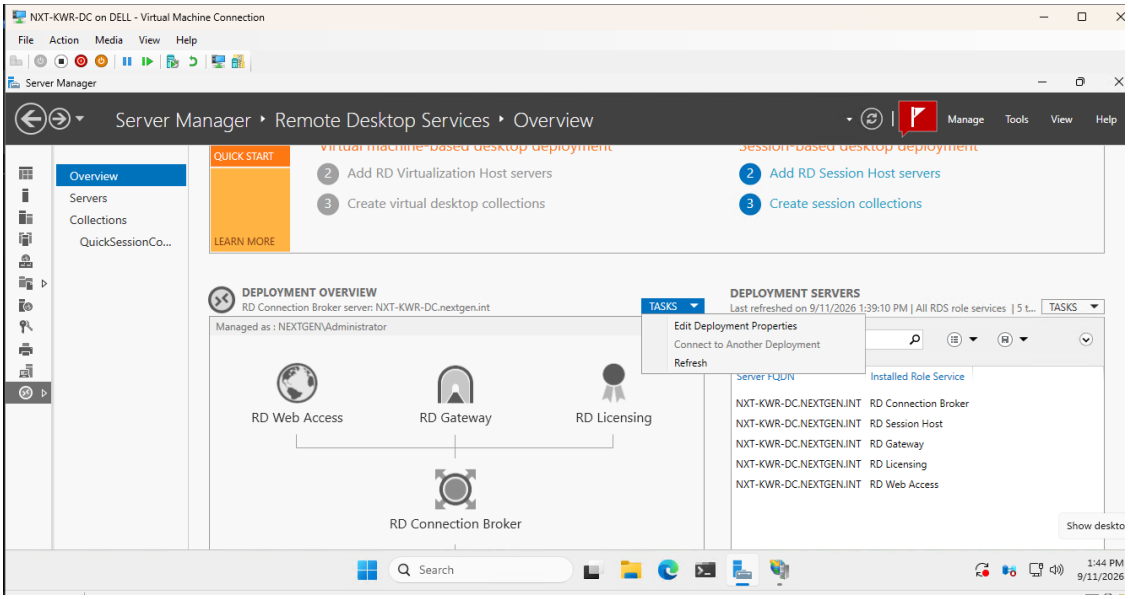


What this screen shows: The Server Certificates feature page (connection path shown as PC01 → Application Pools → Sites). A list of installed certificates is shown, each row giving Name/Issued To, Issued By, and Expiry date — several certificates issued to and by pc01.nextgen.int are listed. The Actions pane on the right offers Import..., Create Certificate Request..., Complete Certificate Request..., Create Domain Certificate..., Create Self-Signed Certificate..., and Enable Automatic Rebind of Renewed Certificate.

What to do here: From here an administrator can create a brand-new domain certificate (Create Domain Certificate...) tied to an internal Certificate Authority, import a certificate obtained elsewhere (Import...), or create another self-signed certificate — whichever certificate is created/imported here becomes available to bind to IIS sites and, indirectly, to RD Gateway/RD Web Access via the Select existing certificate option shown next.

What happens next: This centralised list is what the 'Select existing certificate' option (shown next) draws from — it lets one certificate be reused across multiple role services instead of generating a new self-signed certificate every time.

3.7.4 Back in the RDS deployment overview

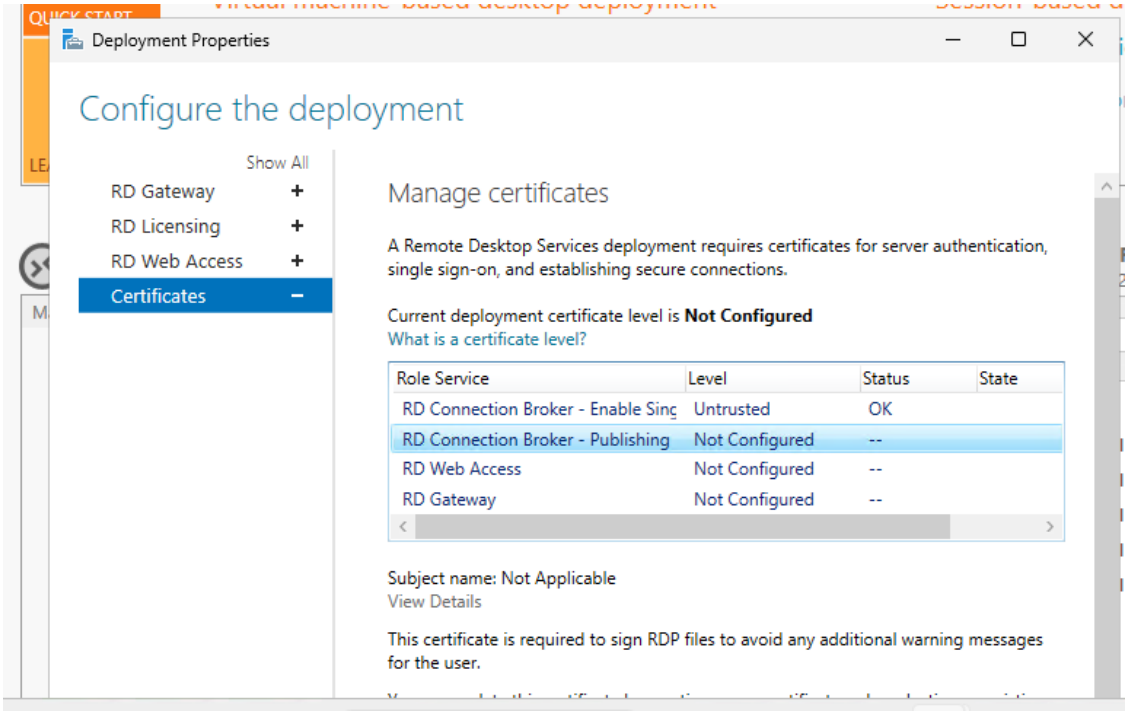


What this screen shows: Server Manager → Remote Desktop Services → Overview, showing the completed deployment diagram: RD Web Access, RD Gateway, and RD Licensing icons all connected to RD Connection Broker with no outstanding plus-icons, and the Deployment Servers table on the right listing NXT-KWR-DC.NEXTGEN.INT against every role service (RD Connection Broker, RD Session Host, RD Gateway, RD Licensing, RD Web Access).

What to do here: Confirm every role service shows as installed against the server, with no warning icons remaining.

What happens next: The full RDS deployment (Broker, Web Access, Gateway, Licensing, Session Host) is now installed end-to-end; remaining configuration work is about the certificate binding and publishing applications, covered next.

3.7.5 Selecting which role service to assign a certificate to

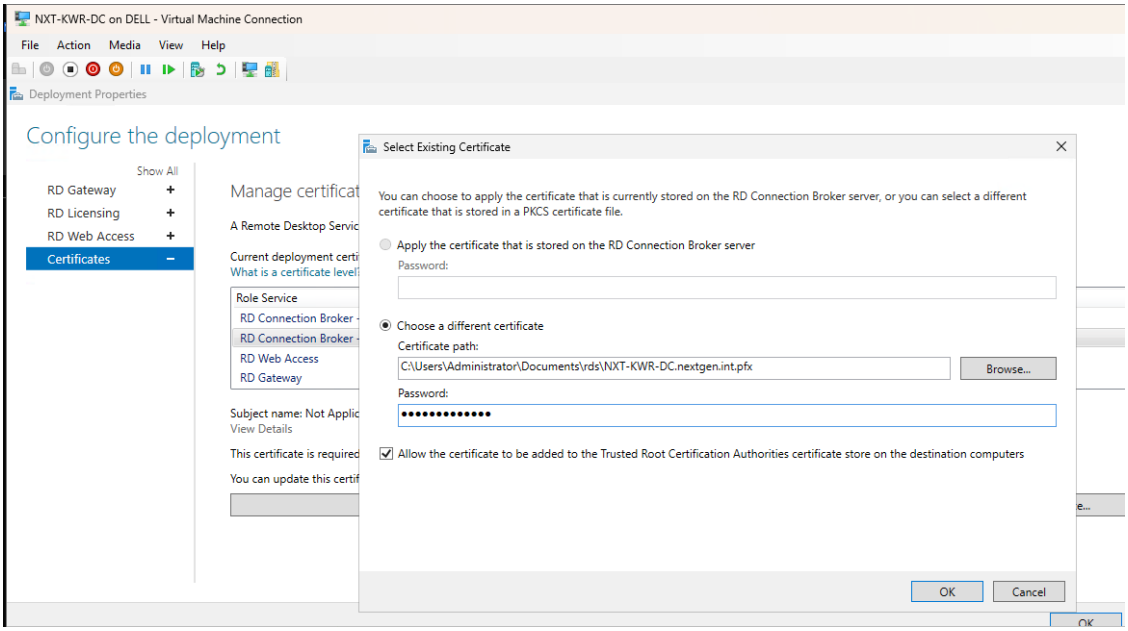


What this screen shows: Deployment Properties → Certificates, with the Role Service list now showing statuses: RD Connection Broker - Enable Sign... = Untrusted / OK, RD Connection Broker - Publishing (selected, highlighted) = Not Configured, RD Web Access = Not Configured, RD Gateway = Not Configured. Below, a note explains this certificate is required to sign RDP files, to avoid additional warning messages for the user.

What to do here: Select the role service that still shows Not Configured (e.g. RD Connection Broker - Publishing) and click Select existing certificate... to reuse the certificate created/managed earlier instead of generating a new one for every role.

What happens next: The Select Existing Certificate dialog opens.

3.7.6 Selecting the existing certificate to apply

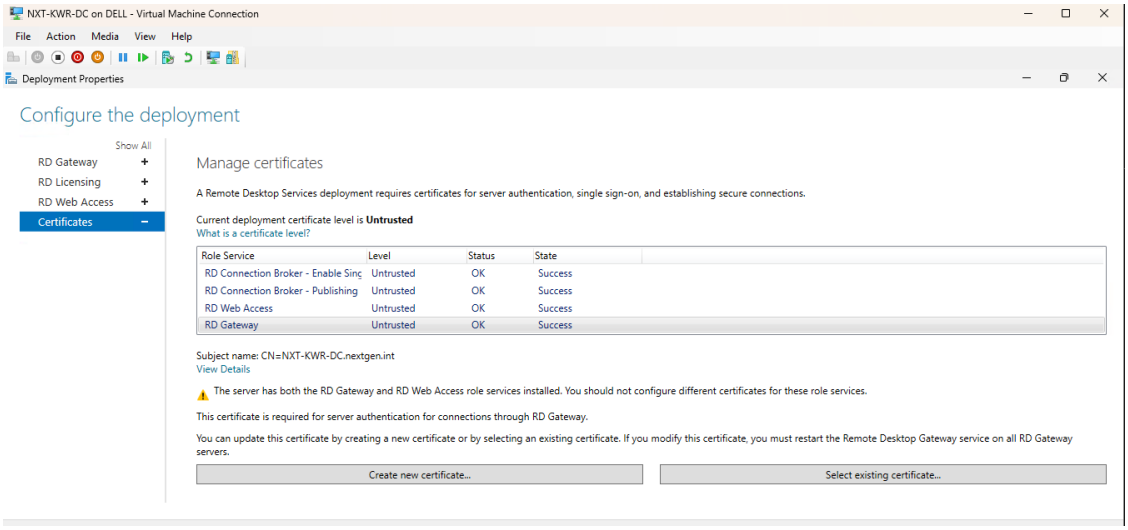


What this screen shows: The Select Existing Certificate dialog. Two radio options: 'Apply the certificate that is currently stored on the RD Connection Broker server' (with a Password field), or 'Choose a different certificate' (selected), which reveals a Certificate path field pre-filled with C:\Users\Administrator\Documents\...\NXT-KWR-DC.nextgen.int.pfx, a Password field (masked, filled in), and a ticked checkbox 'Allow the certificate to be added to the Trusted Root Certification Authorities certificate store on the destination computers'.

What to do here: With 'Choose a different certificate' selected, browse to (or confirm) the .pfx file path created earlier, enter its password, keep the Trusted Root checkbox ticked, and click OK.

What happens next: The same certificate created in step 3.6.2 is now applied to this role service too, instead of a separate certificate being generated for each one — keeping a single, consistent certificate identity across the whole RDS deployment.

3.7.7 All role services now trusted



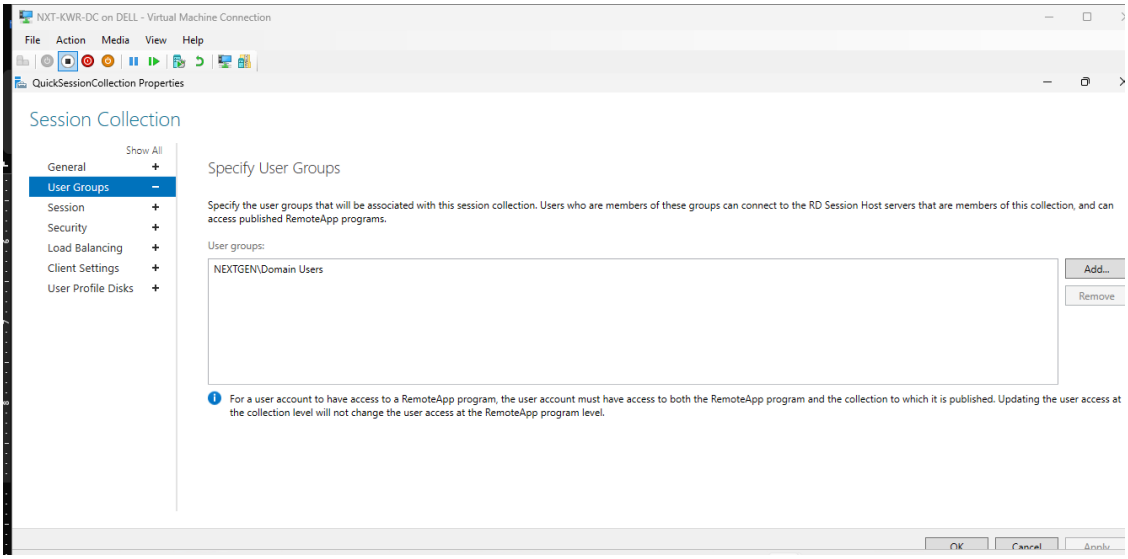
What this screen shows: Deployment Properties → Certificates, now showing every role service — RD Connection Broker - Enable Single Sign-On, RD Connection Broker - Publishing, RD Web Access, RD Gateway — with Level: Untrusted and Status: OK / Success. The current deployment certificate level at the top now reads 'Untrusted'. A note explains the certificate is required for server authentication for connections through RD Gateway, and that RD Gateway/RD Web Access services must be restarted if the certificate is modified.

What to do here: At this point the deployment is functional with a self-signed certificate (shown as 'Untrusted' because it isn't issued by a public/trusted CA — this is expected in a lab and is fixed on real clients by importing the certificate, done in Part 3.8). Click OK/Apply to close.

What happens next: Every RDS role service now uses the same certificate for its HTTPS/TLS endpoints, which is what lets RD Gateway and RD Web Access serve valid-looking HTTPS to clients that have the certificate imported into their Trusted Root store.

3.8 Publishing RemoteApp programs

3.8.1 Assigning the user group to the session collection

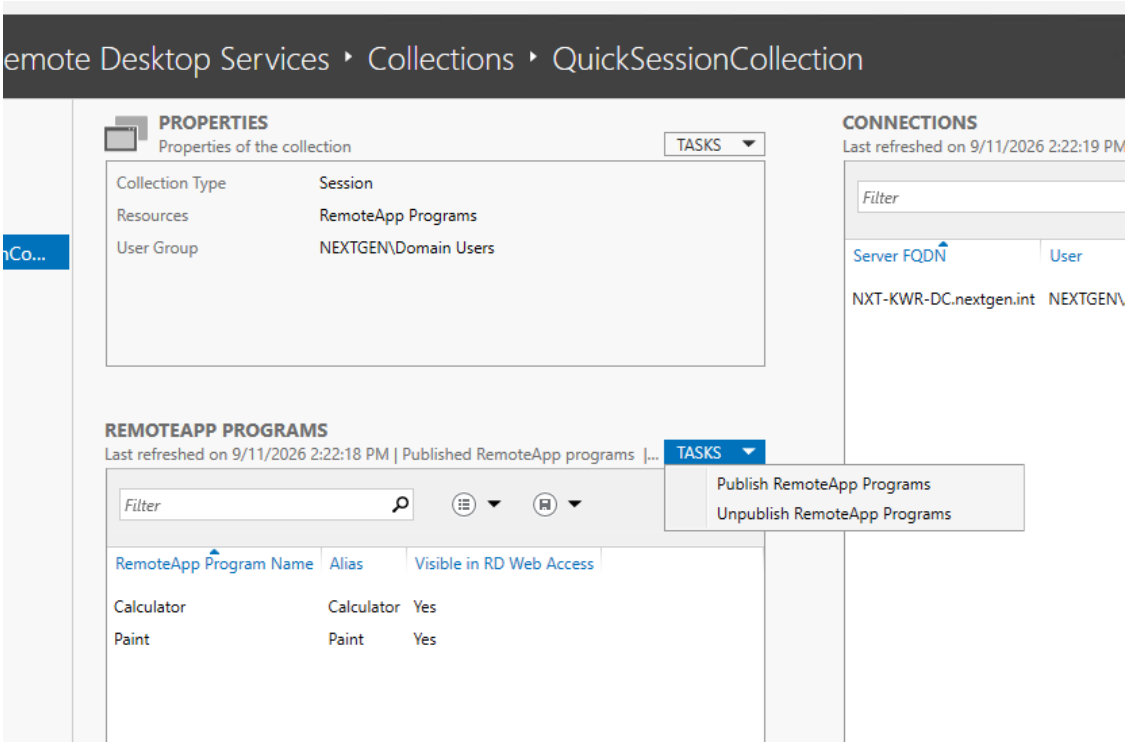


What this screen shows: The QuickSessionCollection Properties dialog, User Groups page. It explains that the user groups associated with this session collection determine who can connect to RD Session Host servers in this collection and access published RemoteApp programs. The User groups list currently contains NEXTGEN\Domain Users, with Add… and Remove buttons alongside.

What to do here: Keep (or add) the appropriate security group here — NEXTGEN\Domain Users is used in this example so that any domain user can access the collection; in a tighter production setup this would usually be narrowed to a specific security group instead of the whole domain.

What happens next: Only members of the listed group(s) will be able to see and open the RemoteApp programs published to this collection — everyone else will be denied even if they can reach the RD Web Access page.

3.8.2 The session collection's RemoteApp Programs list

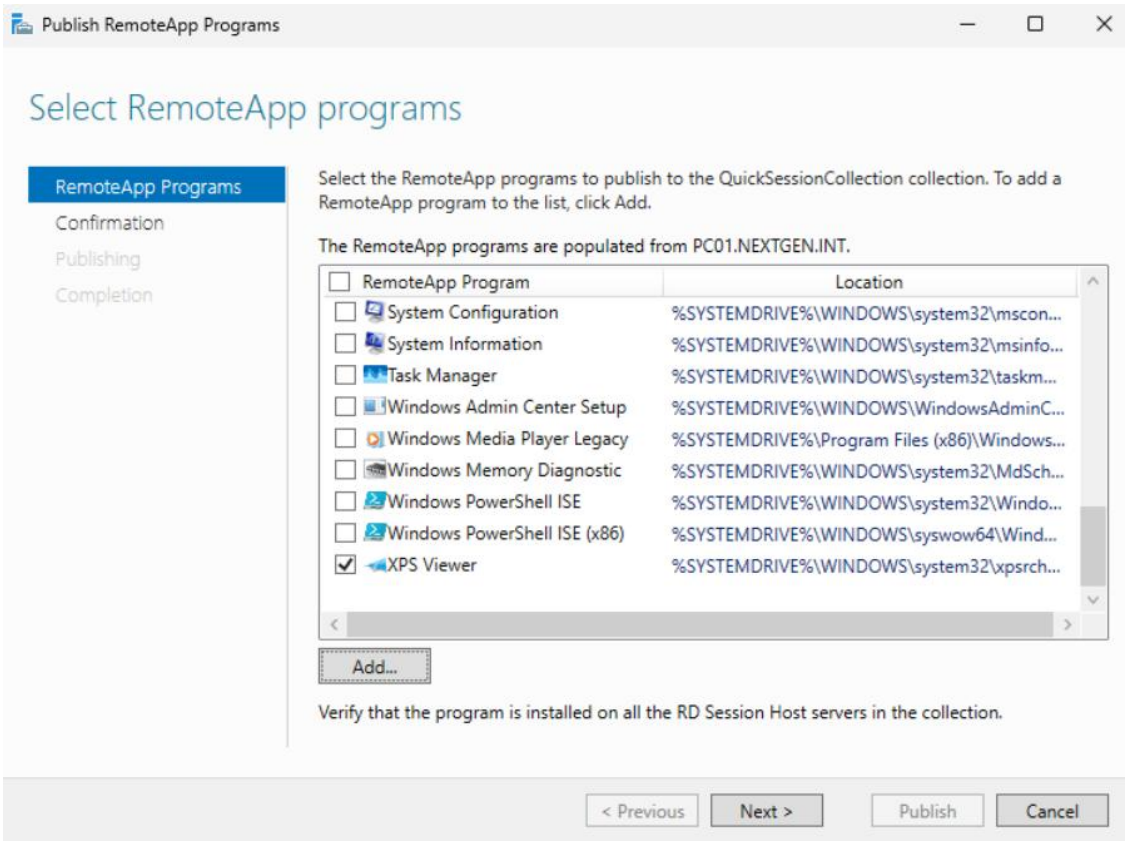


What this screen shows: Remote Desktop Services → Collections → QuickSessionCollection page. A Properties panel on the left shows Collection Type: Session, Resources: RemoteApp Programs, User Group: NEXTGEN\Domain Users. On the right, a Connections panel lists active connections (NXT-KWR-DC.nextgen.int / NEXTGEN\...). Below, a REMOTEAPP PROGRAMS panel currently lists two already-published programs, Calculator and Paint, both marked Visible in RD Web Access: Yes, next to a TASKS dropdown.

What to do here: Click the TASKS dropdown menu to publish additional RemoteApp programs.

What happens next: A menu opens offering Publish RemoteApp Programs and Unpublish RemoteApp Programs (shown next).

3.8.3 Selecting RemoteApp programs to publish

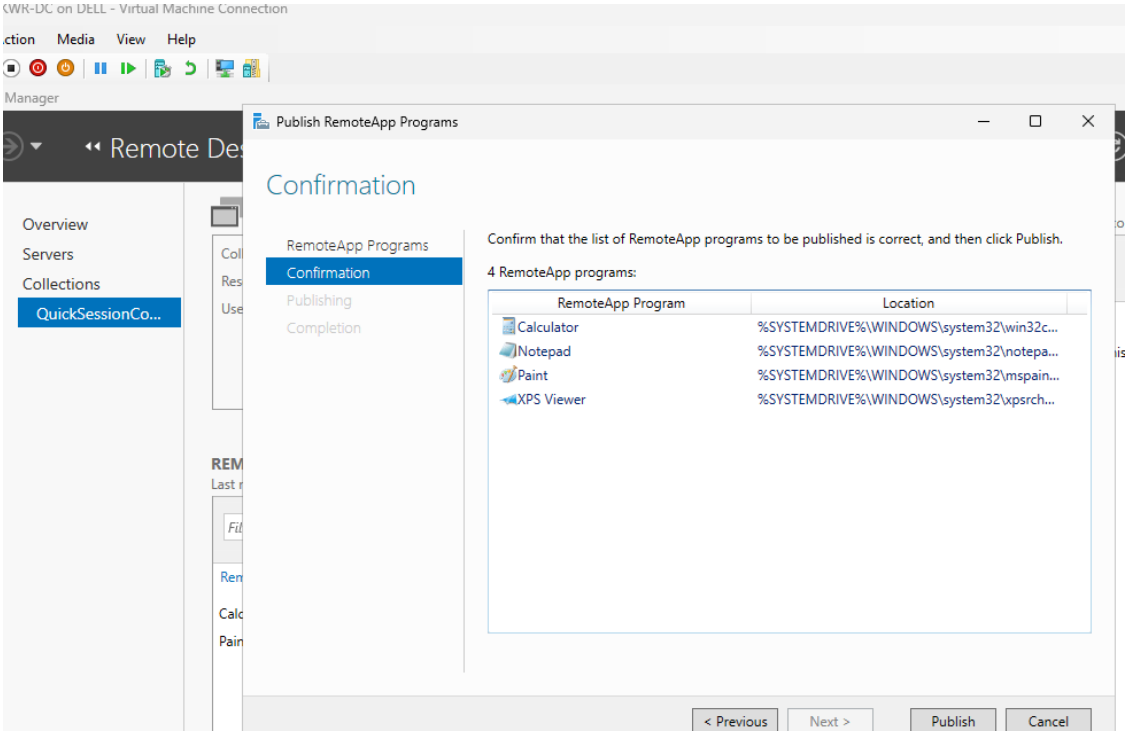


What this screen shows: The Publish RemoteApp Programs wizard, RemoteApp Programs step. A checklist of applications discovered on PC01.NEXTGEN.INT is shown with their installation paths, including System Configuration, System Information, Task Manager, Windows Admin Center Setup, Windows Media Player Legacy, Windows Memory Diagnostic, Windows PowerShell ISE (both 32/64-bit), and XPS Viewer — XPS Viewer is ticked. An Add… button allows adding a program not in the auto-discovered list.

What to do here: Tick every application that should be made available remotely (in this walkthrough XPS Viewer is added alongside the previously published Calculator and Paint, and Notepad is added too, per the confirmation screen next), then click Next.

What happens next: The wizard moves to a confirmation screen listing every program that will be published.

3.8.4 Confirming publication

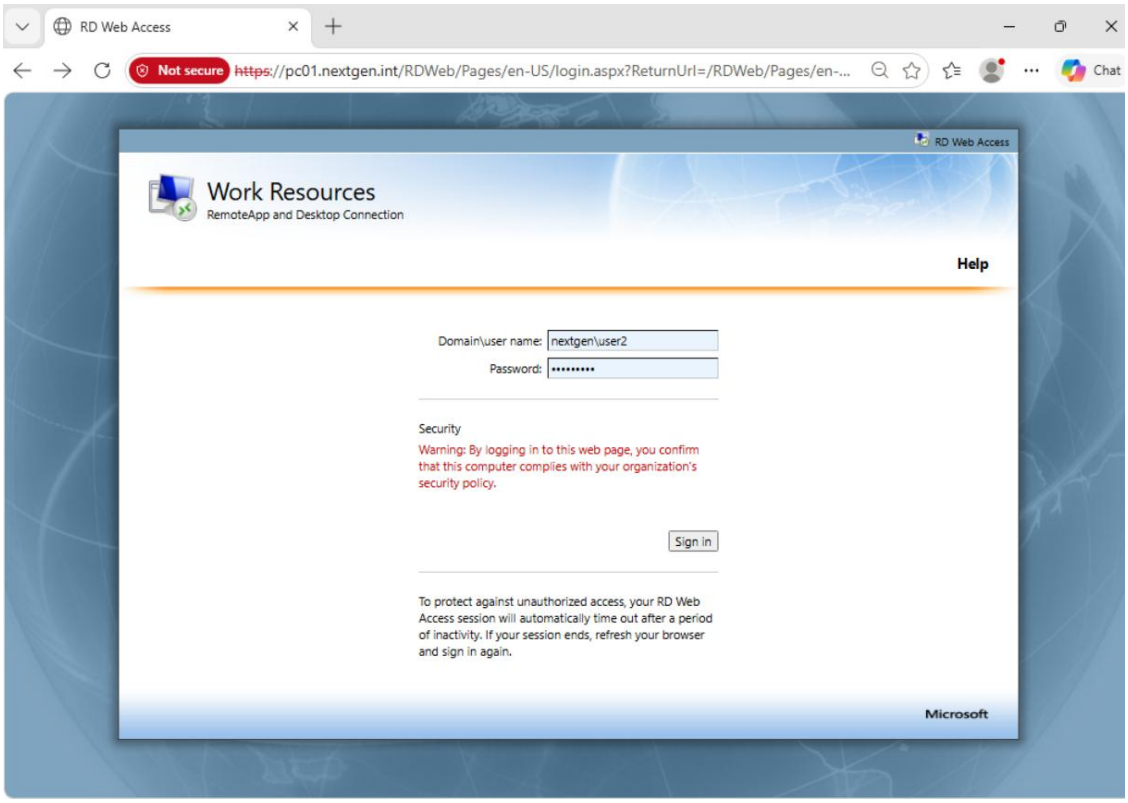


What this screen shows: The Confirmation page lists the 4 RemoteApp programs to be published: Calculator, Notepad, Paint, and XPS Viewer, each with its system32 install path.

What to do here: Review the list and click Publish.

What happens next: RD Connection Broker updates the collection's published resource list, and RD Web Access immediately begins advertising these four apps to authorised users.

3.8.5 Logging into RD Web Access

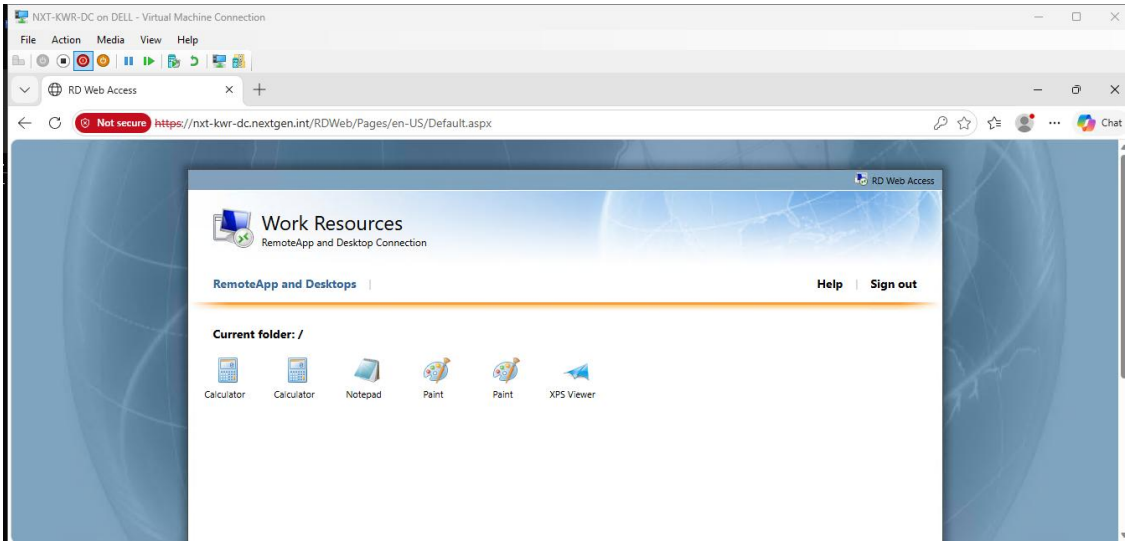


What this screen shows: A browser window at https://pc01.nextgen.int/RDWeb/Pages/en-US/login.aspx, showing the 'Work Resources' RD Web Access sign-in page — a Domain\user name field (pre-filled nextgen\user2) and a Password field, with a Sign in button, plus a note warning that logging in confirms the computer complies with the organisation's security policy.

What to do here: Enter the domain user's credentials (in the form DOMAIN\username) and click Sign in.

What happens next: RD Web Access authenticates the user against Active Directory and, if successful, loads the Work Resources page listing every RemoteApp program that user's group has access to.

3.8.6 The published apps as seen by the user



What this screen shows: The RD Web Access 'Work Resources' page after signing in, showing icons for Calculator, Calculator (a duplicate entry), Notepad, Paint, and XPS Viewer under 'Current folder: /'.

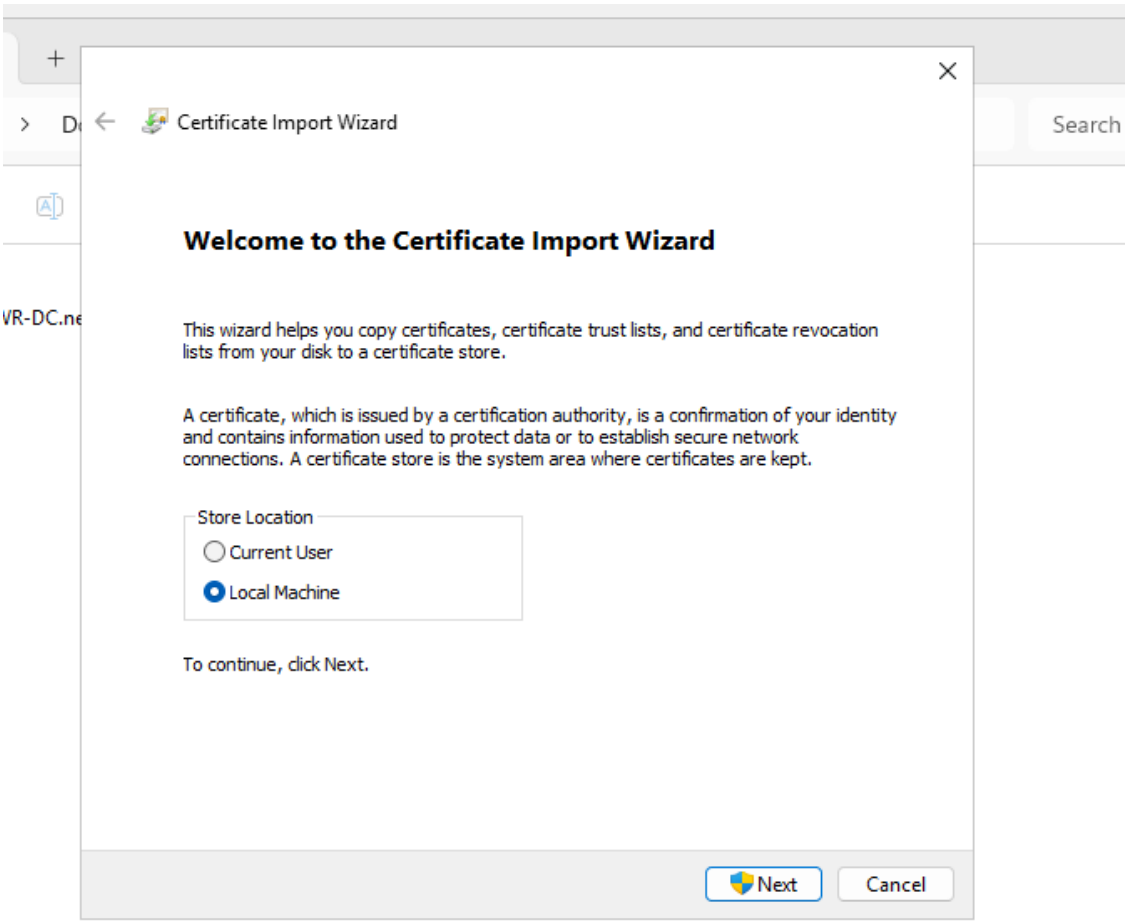
What to do here: The user simply double-clicks any icon to launch that application through RDS.

What happens next: Double-clicking downloads a small .rdp connection file which, once opened, establishes an RDP session routed through RD Gateway to the Session Host, and the chosen application opens in what looks like a locally running window (a RemoteApp session) rather than a full remote desktop.

3.9 Preparing a client PC — installing the RD Gateway certificate

Because the certificate created earlier is self-signed, client computers need it imported into their own Trusted Root Certification Authorities store, otherwise they will see certificate warnings (or, in stricter configurations, be blocked outright) when connecting to RD Web Access / RD Gateway over HTTPS.

3.9.1 Starting the Certificate Import Wizard

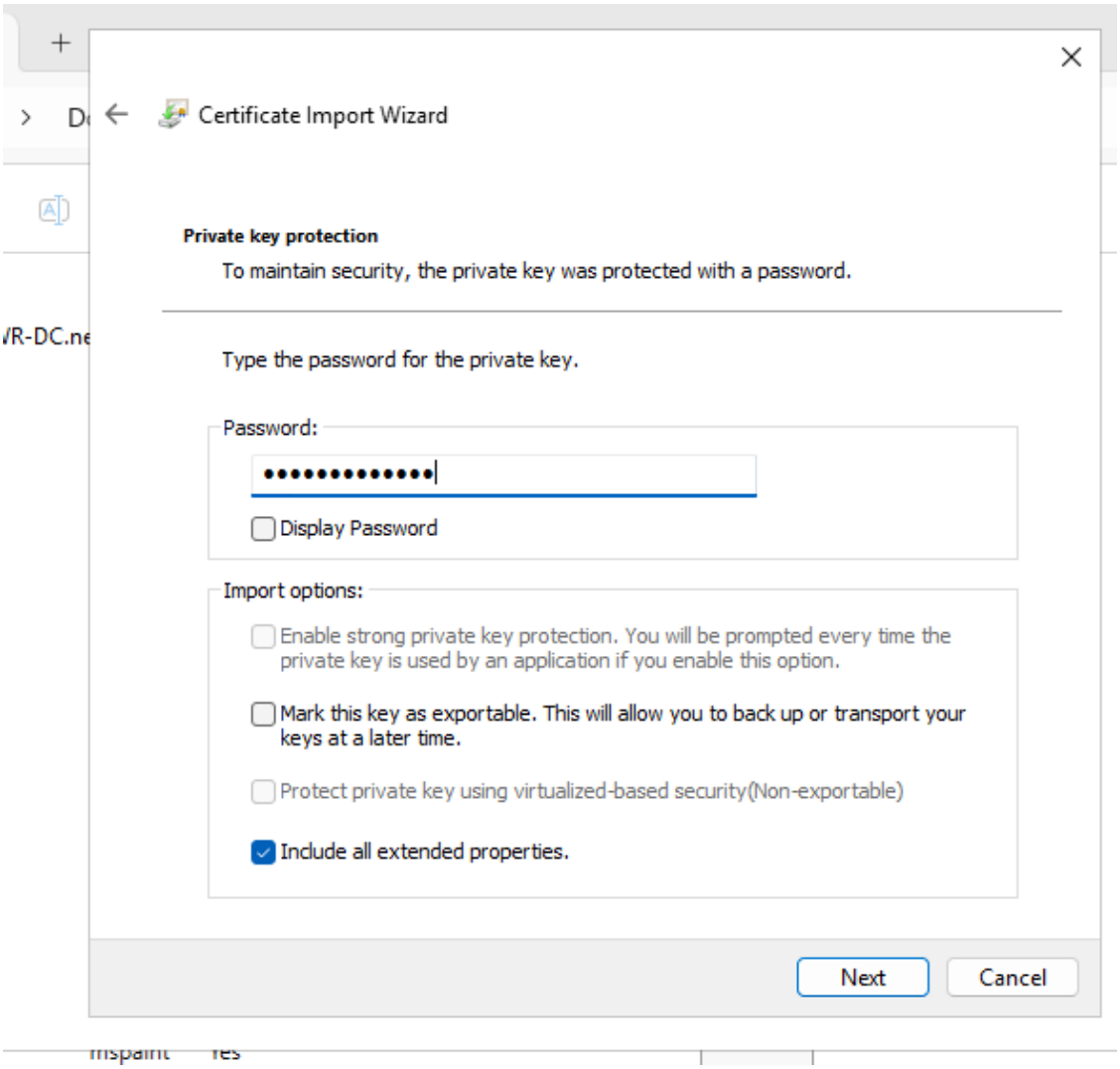


What this screen shows: The Certificate Import Wizard welcome page, explaining that it copies certificates, certificate trust lists, and certificate revocation lists from disk into a certificate store. A Store Location choice is offered: Current User or Local Machine (Local Machine is selected).

What to do here: Select Local Machine rather than Current User, since Local Machine installs the certificate for the entire computer, letting every user and Windows service (such as RD Gateway/RDP itself) trust it — not just the logged-in account. Click Next.

What happens next: (This step typically requires an administrator prompt/UAC elevation, since it modifies the machine-wide certificate store.) The wizard proceeds to locate the .pfx file to import.

3.9.2 Entering the private key password

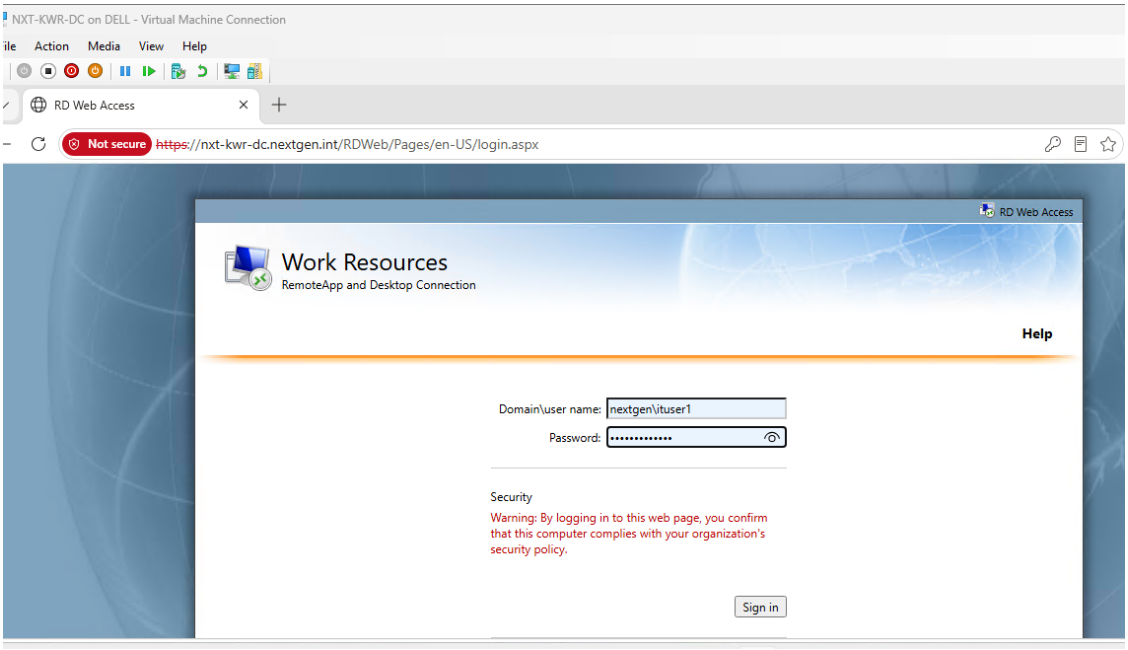


What this screen shows: The Private key protection page, explaining the private key was protected with a password. A Password field is filled in (masked), with a Display Password checkbox, and import options: Enable strong private key protection, Mark this key as exportable, Protect private key using VBS (non-exportable), and Include all extended properties (ticked).

What to do here: Enter the same password that was set when the certificate was created back in step 3.6.2, keep Include all extended properties ticked (this preserves the certificate's intended-use metadata), then click Next.

What happens next: The wizard proceeds to ask which certificate store to place the certificate in (typically 'Place all certificates in the following store' → Trusted Root Certification Authorities), then completes the import.

3.9.3 Signing into RD Web Access from the client



What this screen shows: The RD Web Access login page again, this time reached from the client PC (https://nxt-kwr-dc.nextgen.int/RDWeb/Pages/en-US/login.aspx), now with the certificate trusted so the browser does not show a security warning. Credentials for nextgen\user1 are entered.

What to do here: Enter the domain\username and password for the test user and click Sign in.

What happens next: Because the certificate is now trusted locally, the page loads cleanly (no red 'Not secure' warning blocking access), confirming that the certificate import in the previous two steps worked correctly.

3.9.4 Confirming the app list loads on the client

